

VIKAS PRE-UNIVERSITY COLLEGE

*English  
Notes*  
Volume 1







# English Notes

## Volume 1

### Index

|                                                           |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 1. The Gentlemen of the Jungle - Jane Bown                | 06 |
| 2. The School Boy - William Blake                         | 11 |
| 3. Around a Medieval Cemetery - K.P. Parnack-Smith, Simon | 17 |
| 4. Ope Mambochyan - Victoria Richmond-Brown               | 23 |
| 5. Money Madness - R. H. Lawrence                         | 27 |
| 6. Babar Ali - Manojkumar Mukherjee Sharma                | 31 |
| 7. It's was a tree - Bhadrabati Choudhury                 | 33 |
| 8. Watchman of the Lake - A.R. Simon                      | 39 |
| 9. The Farmer's Wife - P. Lalithakumari (Malay)           | 45 |
| 10. Frederick Douglass                                    | 49 |
| 11. An Old Woman - Aron Emdin                             | 56 |
| 12. Two Gentlemen of Verona - A.D. Green                  | 59 |
| 13. Do not ask of Me, My Love - Gay Ahmed Faris           | 65 |
| 1 PUC English Annual Question Paper 2014                  | 67 |
| 1 PUC English Annual Question Paper 2015                  | 73 |
| 1 PUC English Annual Question Paper 2016                  | 79 |
| 1 PUC English Annual Question Paper 2017                  |    |



# 1. The Gentlemen of the Jungle

James Krüss

## Glossary

|            |   |                                    |
|------------|---|------------------------------------|
| Torrential | = | fall in large amounts              |
| Soothing   | = | calm                               |
| Repute     | = | having good opinion                |
| Endowed    | = | have particular feature or quality |
| Humorous   | = | without stress                     |
| Confine    | = | restrict                           |
| Relevant   | = | connected to the subject           |
| Unfazed    | = | not influenced by others opinion   |
| Tread      | = | to walk                            |
| Dispute    | = | quarrel, disagreement              |
| Recked     | = | valued                             |

## Comprehension 1

### 1. What fever did the elephant ask the man on a rainy day?

On a rainy day, the elephant went to his friend, the man, who had a little hut at the edge of the forest and pleaded to allow him to put his trunk inside the hut, to save him from the torrential rain.

### 2. According to the man his hut had room only for him.

False

### 3. How did the elephant sneak into the man's hut?

The man, out of pity, allowed the elephant to put his trunk into his hut. As soon as the elephant put his trunk inside the hut he slowly pushed his head inside and then flung the man out in the rain and laid down comfortably inside.

#### main two necessary reasons

4. According to the elephant the man can afford to remain in the rain because

The skin of the elephant is delicate.

5. How did the lion decide to solve the problem?

The lion consulted his ministers to appoint a commission of enquiry to solve the problem.

6. What kind of judgment did the man expect?

The man expected the judgment to be in his favour and believed that the hat would eventually be returned to him.

7. Why was the man unhappy with the members of the Commission of Enquiry?

The man was unhappy with the members of the commission of enquiry because no members from man's side were included in it.

8. Why was the man told that only jungle animals would be on the jungle commission?

The man was told that only jungle animals would be in the jungle commission because they felt that no man is well educated about the intricacy/complexity of the jungle law.

9. According to the elephant the man had invited him into the hat

To save the hat from the hurricanes.

10. In whose favour was the judgment given?

The judgment was given in the favour of the elephant.

11. Why did the man accept the suggestion of building a new hat?

The man accepted the suggestion of building a new hat because he had no alternative and feared that his refusal might expose him to danger.

12. How did the man buy peace finally?

The man finally bought peace by getting his big hat, accommodated by all animals, on fire.

#### Comprehension II

1. Why was the commission of enquiry appointed by the king of the jungle?

Ans. *Author* *Dr. Bhanu Pratap* was an African Political leader, but

President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power inequalities of European power. He was criticised later.

Once an Elephant who made a friendship with the man requested to permit to put its trunk into man's hut, to gain protection from the territorial stones. But as it put its trunk, it also put its head and finally flung the man out. This caused dispute between the man and elephant. They began to quarrel with each other, hearing the noise the animals in the nearby forest came to see what was happening. In this turmoil, the lion came roaring and asked how they deer would disturb the peace of the kingdom. The elephant informed him about the dispute. The lion who wanted to maintain tranquility in his kingdom ordered to his ministers to appoint a 'commission of enquiry' to look into the matter and report accordingly.

8. Why do you think animals decide not to have anyone from the man's side on the commission of enquiry?

Ans: Author Jomo Kenyatta was an African Political leader, first President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power inequalities of European power.

As per the lion's order, elephant appointed a 'commission of enquiry', to look into the matter of dispute between the elephant and the man, regarding the possession of the hut. But the commission consists of Mr. Rhinoceros, Mr. Buffalo and Mr. Alligator as its members. Mr. Lion, Fox as its chairman and Mr. Leopard as secretary. But there were no members from the man's side.

Animals wanted man to provide impartial law after the investigation. They thought that it was impossible to include a man because no one from man's side was well educated to understand the intricacy of the jungle law. The animals also believed that they were the members chosen by God, look after the interest of the race, live adequately endowed with the teeth and claws. So he decided not to have any members from the man's side on the commission of enquiry.

9. How did the elephant justify its act of occupying the hut?

Ans: Author Jomo Kenyatta was an African Political leader, first President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power inequalities of European power.

During the proceeding of the Enquiry, Elephant justify its action by

saying that indeed the man himself had invited it to protect his hut from being blown away from hurricanes, as the hurricanes had gained access owing to the unoccupied space in the hut. It was necessary to turn the undeveloped place to some use and so by sitting in it. The elephant felt that it was its sacred duty, which any other animal would have carried out, if they were in a similar situation. In this way elephant justified its action.

4. Do you think the verdict by the commission of enquiry was on the expected lines? Why?

Ans. Author Jomo Kenyatta was an African Political leader, first President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power mongers and European power.

During the trial Mr. Hyena and other chiefs of the jungle took elephant's side and the man was not given even a chance to state his case. So no surprise the verdict came in favour of the elephant.

5. What fate awaited the man each time he built a new house?

Ans. Author Jomo Kenyatta was an African Political leader, first President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power mongers and European power.

The commission of enquiry declared its verdict, it ordered the man to vacate his hut and look for another site, to construct a new hut for him. The man feared that his refusal might expose him to the wrath and claws of the members of commission. So he obeyed as they suggested. But no sooner had he built another hut than Mr. Rhinoceros charged in with force and ordered the man to quit. A rival commission was again appointed to look into the matter and same finding was given. This procedure was repeated until Mr. Buffalo, Mr. Leopard, Mr. Hyena and the rest were all accommodated with new huts.

### Comprehensions III

1. Do you agree with the action of the man at the end? Why?
2. An act of kindness is misunderstood as weakness. Discuss this with reference to the story.
3. 'Peace is costly but is worth the expense'. What is the ironical significance of this statement?



4. Every fable ends with a moral. What moral do you find in this story?

Ans: Jothir Jomo Kenyatta was an African Political leader, later President of Kenya uses this fable 'Gentlemen of the jungle' to expose power mongersness of European powers.

The poet begins the fable in a fable with a moral. An elephant makes a friendship with man. On this pretext it requests him to permit it to put its trunk inside his hut to secure protection from the venemous rain. The man feels pity when he sees the miserable condition of the elephant. Even though his hut was small he allowed the elephant to put its trunk but as soon as the elephant has put its trunk, it also pushes its head and finally bring the man out.

The Mah relies on the legal procedure. But the commission of enquiry deliberately gives the verdict in favour of the elephant. It instructs the man to build another hut, but as soon as he built a new hut, the elephants occupied it. The same procedure repeats until all the members of enquiry commission were accommodated with new huts. The man finally decides that he should adopt some effective methods of protection so, he purposefully constructs a new hut bigger than the earlier one. As expected, the animals claimed their positions and the granted weather the peak over their rights of protection. When they were excluded, the man sets fire to the hut. The fable concludes with the saying that 'Yours is cattle hut is worth the expense which means one must adopt effective measures in order to root out inhuman rule. The animal fails to understand true ability of man. They misjudge his tender inclination as his weakness. But ultimately their over confidence causes their death.

5. Do you think the story can be read as a political satire on colonialism?

Ans: The author Jomo Kenyatta uses this fable 'Gentle men of the jungle' to expose power mongersness of European powers. He uses satirical tone. Satire is used in many works of literature to show foolishness or vice in humans or even in organization or government it used common for example Jonathan swift's *Gulliver's Travels* 1726 especially Book IV the satire on entire human race.

In the late nineteenth century the chief European powers divided Africa

among themselves. They would do this because European men were superior and because the African chiefs did not understand the meaning of the treaties they were asked to sign. As a result Africans lost the land that had traditionally lived and cultivated. Their attitude towards European 'Expansion' is made clear in this fable which reflects the attitude of the Kikuyu people of Kenya towards European land and colonisation.

The author Jomo Kenyatta's expression contempt and dissatisfaction is not direct, it has been expressed indirectly through an extended metaphor known as *Njiginya*. In this fable initially elephant pleaded for permission to put its trunk out, when it was permitted it crept in completely and hung the man out. Such was the regard of Europeans when they first came as missionaries and later as traders. The Europeans imposed their system of law of laws on African Nations they even appointed a governor to rule Africans without consulting them. This filled the air of total dissatisfaction and frustration among the people of Africa. They felt betrayed as we see in the man's case who fights with the elephant for the lost land.

## 2. The School Boy

William Blake

### Glossary

- Nostalgia** : longing for a happier or better time in the past.  
*Translated by Johannes Heller in 1996 (Home in heaven)*
- Bower** : shady place under tree (Metaphor for school)
- Drooping** : and, weal from fatigue
- Away** : somewhere, elsewhere
- Slip it** : slip, wrap
- Stoppit** : Pinch off
- Atheism** : The belief that God does not exist.

### Comprehension 1

- Who, do you think, 'I' refers to in the poem?  
*I refers to William Blake in the poem.*
- 'Sweet company' refers to  
*Black, Huttonian's form and land's song.*
- What drives the boy's joy away?  
*The very thought of going to school drives the boy's joy away.*
- How do the little ones spend the day in the school?  
*The little ones spend the day in the school by sighing (grief) and dream (daydreaming).*
- What does 'cage' stand for in the poem?  
*Cage stands for school, where the children are entrapped.*
- Pick the phrase from the following which does not refer to formal schooling.  
*Fruits are gathered*

1. Relate the seasons mentioned under column A with the stages of life.

1. Spring-Childhood 2. Summer-Youth 3. Winter-Old age

### Comprehension: II

1. What does the school boy have to do on a summer morn? What drives his joy away?

William Blake's *The School Boy* is a typical example of Blake's songs of Experience. Blake suggests that the educational system of his day destroys the joyful innocence of youth. Blake himself was largely self-educated and did not venture the drudgery of the classroom as a child. This poem is less harsh and more playful than most of Blake's other works.

In the poem the poet speaks in the persona of a school child that wakes upon the morning. He loves to rise early in summer morning to enjoy the cheeping sound of the birds. Daisies and hyacinths and the melody of skylark singing. But all the happiness gets driven away when he realises that he has to go to school. The main theme is the sorrow that the boy feels at the very thought of going to school. While he wishes to enjoy the summer. He has the obligation to go to a closed space, when he wishes to be very much outside in the nature.

2. Describe the boy's experience in the school.

William Blake, poet and painter had little formal education. His first work as an artist is the series, 'Innocence to the Book of Job'. His collections of poetry include *Poetical Sketches*, *Songs of Innocence*, *Marrage of Heaven and Hell*. 'The school boy' is a lyric from the *Songs of Experience*.

Child loves to rise early in summer morning to enjoy but all the happiness disappears when he realises that he has to go to school. The main theme is the sorrow that the boy feels at the very thought of going to school. While he wishes to enjoy the summer.

The boy longs for the freedom of the outdoors and cannot take delight in his book. He is compelled to experience many anxious hour. The image of the bird is used in the poem. The birds sing happily when they are free but if they are in a cage they cannot do it the same way. In the same way the boy feels he is imprisoned at school.

School like in school and the bird in the cage are seen as equivalents not only at the natural level under physical captivity but at the spiritual level too. Both represent the caging and entrapping of imagination.

The image of the plant applies to the school boys present and future. The young plant like the young child is tender and vulnerable the way it is treated at this stage. It takes its later capacity to bear fruit. Just as food gathered in autumn is necessary to ensure survival through the winter, so also the experiences of joy and the freedom of the imagination are necessary for a person's capacity to live well and survive the inevitable griefs of life.

3. According to the poet how does formal education stifle a learner's potential?

William Blake is called a Transitional poet. He wrote social poetry which is concerned with the oppressed class of people. The school boy is a lyric from the Songs of Experience.

The poem starts in a very positive way but it changes radically and the tone is very pessimistic. The poet wishes his readers to see the difference between the freedom of imagination offered by the close contact with nature and the repression or subjugation of the soul caused by so-called education. This poem depends upon 3 minor related images, the school boy, the bird and the plant. All three are dependent upon the way in which they are treated by human beings.

Poet appeals that adults must realize that children are like plants, which needs to be nurtured and given proper care. They have to bear fruit later on. School should be the place where children are allowed to think freely.

On the other hand mentioning things to learn history, civics literature as these subjects not only stifle the kids, people need to face life in a more global or better way, but they also sharpen the mind and expand points of view.

So I think the poet is not opposing against education. But he wishes that school should provide students with challenges, competition and opportunities to enhance their creativity. It should be a place where children are provided with for practical play and develop at their own pace.

### Comprehension III

1. Formal schooling not only takes away the joy of childhood but also hinders the child's growth forever. Explain.

(2)

- a. Do you think the poet is arguing against education? Discuss.

William Blake's *The School Boy* is a typical example of Blake's songs of Experience. Blake suggests that the educational system of his day destroys the joyful innocence of youth. Blake himself was largely self-educated and did not value the discipline of the classroom as a child. This poem is less harsh and more playful than most of Blake's other works.

The poem starts in a very positive way but it changes radically and the tone is very pessimistic. The poet wishes his readers to see the difference between the freedom of imagination offered by the close contact with nature and the repression or subjugation of the self caused by a forced education. This poem depends upon a series related images, the school boy, the bird and the plant. All three are dependent upon the way in which they are treated by human beings. In the poem, the poet speaks in the person of a school child that wakes up in the morning. The poet says the boy gets happiness in playing of bird and watching the butterfly. The nature is a sweet company to him. But when the boy realizes that he has to go to school, nature loses interest, as he enters the school he spends the time in irritation and anxiety. The main theme is the concept that the boy feels at the very thought of going to school. While he wishes to enjoy the summer. He has the obligation to go to a closed space, where he wishes to be very much outside in the nature.

The boy longs for the freedom of the outdoors and cannot take delight in his book. He is compelled to experience many summer hours. The image of the bird is used in the poem. The birds sing happily when they are free but if they are in a cage they cannot do it the same way. In the same way the boy feels he is imprisoned at school. School boy is a bird and the bird in the cage are seen as equivalents not only at the natural level under physical subjection but at the spiritual level too. Both represent the caging and constricting of imaginative vision.

The image of the plant applies to the school boy's present and future.

The young plant like the young child is tender and vulnerable the way it is treated at this stage, dictates its later capacity to bear fruit. Just as food gathered in autumn is necessary to ensure survival through the winter, so also the experiences of joy and the freedom of the imagination are necessary for a person's capacity to live well and survive the inevitable griefs of life.

Piut appeals that adults must realize that children are like plants, which needs to be nurtured and given proper care. Then later to bear fruit later on. School should be the place where children are allowed to think freely and all round development is guaranteed.

On the other hand interesting things to learn history, art's literature in these subjects not only serve as the tools, people need to live life in a more global or better way, but they also sharpen the mind and expand points of view.

So I think the poet is not arguing against education. But he states that school should provide students with challenges, competition and opportunities to enhance their creativity. It should be a place where children are provided with for practical play and doing at their own pace.





### 3. Around a Medicinal Creeper

K.P. Paramasandhya Teyssan

|                     |   |                               |
|---------------------|---|-------------------------------|
| Illnesses           |   |                               |
| Rolling             | 1 | separating                    |
| Mythification       | 1 | artifice                      |
| Spoolable           | 2 | quarrel                       |
| Spouts              | 1 | gushes out suddenly           |
| Capiously           | 1 | overflowing                   |
| Cock and bull story | 1 | an absurd story               |
| Falsely             | 2 | build/ build up               |
| Believe             | 2 | improve                       |
| Struggle            | 1 | come across                   |
| Willhook            | 1 | make down/ catch              |
| Pathologist         | 1 | a doctor who studies diseases |
| All and sundry      | 1 | several others                |
| Excruciate          | 1 | humiliate                     |
| Apparently          | 1 | evidently                     |
| Secret patient      | 1 | disguise of medication        |
| Power               | 1 | power                         |

#### Comprehension-I

##### 1. What did Maa do when they found the creeper?

Anna brought a bundle of creeper to tie the eyes frames. Maa opened the bundle and saw a medicinal creeper. They went in search of it and when they found it, Maa caught hold of the twigs and tied it to the nearby tree.

2. Mention the curse about the medicinal plant.

Mara narrated that the medicinal creeper has been cursed by a rope. The verse is that when someone needs this plant, they will not find it.

3. What surprised the white man?

Mara, son who had gone to the forest to bring some beehive hives. While cutting them, he accidentally cut his hand. His artery was cut and it resulted in profuse bleeding. Someone brought some leaves and pressed it against the wound and covered with a cloth. Then, he went to the white man for proper dressing and treatment. The white man of Haldhabala removed the leaf and was surprised to see that there was neither wound nor any blood although his clothes were stained with blood.

4. How did the mongpoo and the crevial cure themselves of snake bite?

The mongpoo and crevial hunt snakes and in this process sometimes they are bitten by them. Then, they immediately chew particular medicinal leaf and get cured from the poison.

5. Why had Mara lost his tooth on the right side?

Once Mara had laid a trap to catch rabbits in the forest. He was worried that somebody else may get there before him in the morning and take away his catch. So, he went into the forest before daybreak. The trap was empty. His rabbit had walked into it. Since there was a stream flowing nearby Mara decided to brush his teeth and wash his face before trekking back home. He broke a small stick from a nearby plant and brushed it third or fourth time. He felt a sour taste in the mouth. He took some water from the stream and put it into his mouth to chase and spit it out. To his surprise, all the teeth which had been touched by that stick had fallen off. Thus Mara had lost his teeth on the right side.

6. What did Mara's wife find on opening the packet of meat?

Mara and his friend had caught a barking deer. They skinned and cleaned it and divided the meat. Mara covered his share of meat with certain leaves and took it home. His wife prepared the mutton with spices, put the water to boil and opened the packet with the leaves. To her surprise, she found a live wild buck instead of the meat.

7. What happened when the milk was mixed with juice of the creeper's leaves?

Milk and leaves were mixed thoroughly in a mixer and poured out into a vessel. For a couple of minutes nothing happened. After sometime it became firm and rubbery. When the vessel was inverted the whole thing fell out like a molded cast.

8. When would the medicines lose their potency according to the belief of the native doctors?

According to the native doctors, if they tell others about their medicines, the medicines would lose their potency.

### Comprehension II

1. How long did it take the narrator to learn the facts about the medicinal creeper? What does it signify?

The writer K.P. Ponnambalam Tiyarai is a prominent Kannada writer, novelist, ornithologist, painter, and environmentalist.

He was with Mary and his friends for a long time to learn more about the medicinal herbs. It took almost twenty years for the author to learn about the medicinal creeper, all because of the unwillingness of the local people to share their knowledge regarding these medicinal plants. People those who know something about the value of these plants do not let out the secret because of the belief that if it is shared, it may lose its potency. More than that sufficient Research work has not taken place. The natives are aware that some plants are medicinal but they are not aware of the exact benefit from that plant.

This signifies that there were a lot of myths regarding this creeper. Nobody was sure of the type of disease that it could cure, its availability, in what form it must be taken and so on.

2. What does the incident of Mary's wife throwing the leaves into the fire tell us about Indians in general?

The writer K.P. Ponnambalam Tiyarai is a prominent Kannada writer, novelist, ornithologist, painter, and environmentalist.

Mary and his friend had caught a bucking deer. They skinned and cleaned it and divided the meat. Mary received his share of meat with certain bones and took it home. His wife prepared the mutton with

spices, put the spices in hot oil and spread the packet with the leaves. To her surprise, she found a live wild boar instead of the meat. In anger and out of frustration she threw those leaves into the fire, while Mera watched the boar. Mera's wife is naturally scared and ignorant about the uses of the leaf. When an unusual incident of a meat turning into a live boar happened, she was uninterested to find out the cause for such an incident. She ignorantly threw the leaves into fire, thus remaining ignorant about her own local medicines. This tells us that Indians have a casual attitude towards the medicinal plants though it can do wonders.

### 2. How was Krishna cured of his illness?

The writer K.P. Pannachandran Tiyasri is a prominent Kannada writer, novelist, short-story writer, journalist and environmentalist.

Krishna was the erstwhile husband of the author. He had stopped smoking in the estate sometime ago and was driving a rickshaw. When he changed his job, he started passing blood with his stools. He appeared tired, hairless and had wheezing. It was thought to be piles. The only allopathic treatment for piles was surgery, which was expensive. More than that he was very scared of surgery, therefore he tried to seek the help of a Malayali Shalim, who had an an earlier woman cured him of boils on his body.

The Shalim was now an old man, therefore he advised Krishna himself to go and find the medicinal creeper. He was asked to dig out the tuberosous root of the medicinal creeper and mix it with milk and drink for five days. Within a day his piles improved. He was completely cured in five days. The author suspects the plant to be the same medicinal creeper which Mera and Appanna had used to tie around the tree.

### COMPREHENSION III

1. Do you think the author is suggesting that Indian herbal medicine is better/safer than allopathic medicine?

OR

What has made the modern man lose the knowledge of traditional medicines? Do you think Ayurveda will make a comeback in a successful way?

The writer K.P. Pannachandran Tiyasri is a prominent Kannada

writer, novelist, sociobiologist, painter, and environmentalist. He is trying to suggest that Indian Herbal Medicine is better and safer than allopathic medicine.

The belief of the native doctors that if they reveal things related to their medicine, it would lose its potency has resulted in the loss of knowledge of traditional medicine. People who are benefited from these medicines usually fabricate or exaggerate the facts and thus it is mistaken to be serious. People like Mary and his wife were ignorant and neglected the significance of the medicinal creeper and thus took the medicine almost twenty years to treat. If there was some Truth in what Mary and other illiterates claimed.

The author tries to show that Indian herbal medicine can do wonders, when allopathic medicine becomes a failure or settles as the one with only efforts than benefits, through surgery. He quotes the example of his maternal grandfather Kishore, who was troubled by heat boils all over his body and got treated by a Malayali Sadhu within ten days and then the pills treatment by the same Sadhu. The effect was seen on the first day itself and within five days everything was under control because of herbal medicine.

Allopathic Practitioners have regarded Ayurveda as 'Backward' but the reality is that there is a wealth of knowledge to be explored in the Indian Herbal Medicine. Today people are now giving more importance to the herbal remedies and other products having a tag 'herbal'. This shows that 'Ayurveda' will make a comeback.

2. "Our Natural Resources are our vital resources." Explain the statement in the light of several developmental projects that are being promoted today.

The writer K.P. Flamenchandan Trijani is a prominent Kannada writer, novelist, sociobiologist, painter, and environmentalist. He is trying to suggest that Indian Herbal Medicine is better and safer than allopathic medicine.

Natural resources are indeed the vital resources. In this story we realize the importance of natural resources such as medicinal herbs. The mismanagement of these natural resources has led to various diseases and natural calamities, global warming, climatic changes, new diseases

and ecosystems. Water, air, land and space have been polluted beyond imagination. We have lost precious fish, flora and fauna in the name of some developmental projects.

Most of the resources that are put into existence are non-exhaustible resources. It is ideal on our part that we undertake some developmental projects in order to conserve the wealth of nature. Recycling the natural resources and finding alternate sources of energy would help us conserve the precious natural resources.

Harvesting solar energy for various purposes in the form of solar cells, ovens and heaters will help save a lot of other resources. Rain water Harvesting should be made compulsory in order to save water. Opting for alternative sources like wind energy and tidal energy to generate electricity can be utilized. Finally, by following the principles of 3R's Reduce, Reuse and Recycle, one can conserve the natural resources for the generations to come.

## 4. Oru Manushyan

English: Muhammad Basheer

Translated from Malayalam by V Abhilash titled 'A Man'

### Glossary:

|               |   |                                   |
|---------------|---|-----------------------------------|
| Vague         | = | strange                           |
| Perilous      | = | perplexing or dangerous situation |
| Befall        | = | to happen to some                 |
| Beaten        | = | worn                              |
| Notion        | = | a thought, idea                   |
| Diary         | = | ghostly/haunt                     |
| Grasp         | = | closed with hand/ cut out roughly |
| Stark         | = | completely/ bare                  |
| Intact        | = | not damaged, consisting unjoined  |
| Insignificant | = | unimportant                       |

### Comprehensions:

- How far was the big city from the narrator's home town?  
The big city was some thousand five hundred miles away from the narrator's home town.
- Where did the narrator stay in the big city?  
The narrator lived in a big city in the valley of a mountain and he stayed in that city in a very small dingy room on a dirty street and carried on teaching profession.
- For money people would do any thing, even commit murder.
- What was the narrator doing to earn a living?  
The narrator taught the skill of writing addresses to migrant labourers from since thirty till eleven in the night.

5. \_\_\_\_\_ was considered great education there.

Learning to write an address in English.

6. What reason did the narrator give for sleeping all day and having food in the evening?

The narrator slept whole day and woke up in the evening to have his meal because he wanted to save the expense of drinking his morning tea and eating noon meal.

7. How much money did the narrator have in his pocket as his life's savings?

The narrator had fourteen rupees in his wallet as his life's savings.

8. The man who came forward to pay the narrator's bill was \_\_\_\_\_

A man with a red turban.

### Comprehension II

1. Describe the people and the place where the incident took place.

The writer Yusef Mohammad Badiar is a well known Malayalam short story writer and novelist. He gives description of a very gloomy atmosphere where the incident took place. Author stayed in a very small, dingy room on a dirty street, where he taught the skill of writing addresses to migrant labourers. He had a very vague notion about human beings. He considers that people around him are ruthless and cruel and their main aim was to get money by fair or foul means. Murder, robbery and pick pocketing was daily occurrence of that place. By tradition, the people were professional soldiers who migrated to distant places and lost out money on interest. Many others served as watchmen in hanks, mills and large commercial establishments in big cities. They valued money more than anything. For money they would do anything, even commit murder. Most of them were sadist who sought pleasure by torturing or humiliating other people.

2. What was the routine of the narrator in the city?

The writer Yusef Mohammad Badiar is a well known Malayalam short story writer and novelist. He is known for his sympathetic portrayal of the joys and sorrows of ordinary life. The narrator stayed in a small, dingy room on a dirty street. He made his living by teaching English to some migrant labourers from 8.30 to 11 in the night. He



taught them to write the addresses in English. Just to avoid the expense of morning tea and afternoon meals, he slept whole day and woke up only at least in the evening. This was his daily routine.

3. Give an account of the embarrassing experience of the narrator at the restaurant.

OR

4. A stranger saved the day for the narrator. How?

The writer Valium Muhammad Basheer is a well known Malayalam short story writer and novelist. He is known for his sympathetic portrayal of the joys and sorrows of ordinary life. One day the author went out to have tea and meal. He was in a suit and had fourteen rupees in his wallet. The bill amounted to eleven annas. But when he checked his pocket, he was shocked to find that his wallet was missing. The narrator found himself caught in a dangerous situation. The owner of the restaurant thought that he was lying and threatened him to grasp his eyes and ordered him to take off his coat, shirt, dhot and finally trousers. The narrator thought that the owner would cheat his eyes out and send him naked. But he was rescued by a stranger who was a tall handsome man with red turban, and wearing white trousers. He had blue eyes which was common in that place. The man paid the bill and told him to put on his clothes. On enquiring, the man said that he had no money and thus remained a stranger. In this way the stranger saved the day for the narrator.

### Comprehension: III

1. Does this story talk about transformation in a person? Discuss.

The writer Valium Muhammad Basheer is a well known Malayalam short story writer and novelist. He is known for his sympathetic portrayal of the joys and sorrows of ordinary life.

Yes, this story is about the transformation of a poor person into a more considerate and humane person. The author is a far off place from his native land is struggling to earn his bread. Sometimes he foregoes his morning tea and afternoon lunch to cut his expenses. It so happens one evening after consuming a full meal and a cup of tea, he realises that his wallet that contained fourteen rupees was missing. This was followed by threats from the restaurant keeper. When he was on the verge of getting stripped, a big complexioned man, six feet tall, with a red

rusty and white trousers with blue eyes and bushy hair momentary appeared as a God man to save him. He pays the eleven rupees and takes the author to a deserted bridge. There he asks him to pick his wallet among the five wallets he had hidden. By experiencing this pathetic incident, the author changes his pessimistic notion and becomes more considerate and flexible and concludes that the villain too have a heart and is flexible in his thoughts and considerations.

7. Do you think the restaurant keeper was over reacting when the waitress could not pay the bill? If so, what accounts for his behaviour?

The writer Vithoon Muhammed Bashree is a well known Malayalam short story writer and novelist. He is known for his sympathetic portrayal of the joys and sorrows of ordinary life.

The inhabitants of the big city in the valley of a mountain were cruel and known for robbery, pick pocketing and murder. Money was highly valued by them. They would even commit murder for money.

It so happened that the narrator took up a profession of teaching English to migrant labourers in that place. To save the expense he would forego his morning tea and noon lunch. One evening as usual he went to a crowded restaurant and ate a full meal and drank tea. But to his horror he realised his wallet has been picked by someone. He hurries to the owner of the restaurant about the same. The restaurant keeper with a loud laughter caught him by the lapels of his coat and cried out loudly saying that such tricks would not work there and if he fails to pay the bill, his eyes would be gouged out. Here the restaurant keeper was a little over reacting and drawing the attention of the crowd. He was rude and his act was a humiliating one when he decided to strip the author and gouge his eyes.

## 5. Money Madness

B. H. Lawrence

Glossary:

- Multitude** : a very large number of people
- Collective** : action done by all members of one society
- Tremor** : something caused by fear
- Quail** : surprised, hostile
- Cowed** : cowed before somebody; as in great fear, humbled oneself
- Delirious** : a mental disturbance when the person is not able to think/speak clearly.
- Usher** : guide
- Extremes** : limit, end
- Humiliation** : embarrassment, degradation

### Comprehension I

1. How do people feel when they give
  - A. One Pound?
  - B. Ten Pound?

A. One Pound People are not happy to give away the pound note, they feel a pang.

B. Ten Pound If a person thinks to give away ten pound note, then he feels tremors within him and feels dejected. He never gives a lot of notes.
2. "Money has got no down" it means  
It has made its slaves.
3. How are people without money, usually treated?  
The people without money are usually treated as beggars, they are humiliated, degraded by all.

4. What things should be made available free of cost?

Food, fire, shelter should be made available free of cost 'to all and sundry'.

5. The speaker is frightened of

Having no money

6. What happens if we do not regain our sanity about money?

If we do not regain our sanity about money we will start killing each other for money.

### Comprehension: III

1. Collective madness about money affects the individuals also. How does the poem bring this out?

Or

2. What according to the poet, might happen if people do not regain sanity about money? What solution does he offer?

D. H Lawrence was a prominent twentieth century English writer. He is noted for his novel especially 'Sons and Lovers' 'The Rainbow' and 'Women in Love'.

In the poem 'Money Madness' the poet presents materialistic perspective of his fellow human beings. The poet goes on to present a future which happens in a near-future society.

'Money Madness' by D.H Lawrence is a critical evaluation of the cash after affairs that are visible all around us in the modern day world. Money has become a powerful player in societies of today and holds primary importance in the modern day life style. The poet, through his pen, has tried to exemplify this situation and present the social and moral degradation. The poet says that wherever we look there is madness for money; infact money can be termed as metaphor for the word madness. And this madness is not on small or individualistic levels. It is the madness of the multitudes, is madness unimaginable and at levels incredible. Every person in this world carries his share of this madness. The poet doubts that there exists a human in this world who hands out a pound note to someone without feeling a pang at heart. No matter how subtle he may feel while giving away the note, his heart always wishes if only he could do all that good without having to take out a note from his own pocket. When that note turns to a ten pound

same. His experience real troubles within him. He troubles as if he has been walled. Money makes us fearful in front of it. It makes us fearful and a sense of apprehension and stress grips us, as we try to overcome it.

It has an exaggerating power to influence our life. But in the broader sense, it is not the money that we are terrified of, but it is the machine that mankind shows for it, the multitude machines that gives money such an undervalued status in the society of today. Poor feels that no one cares for moral values and behavior. material society judges a man by his riches. If one has no money then he will deserve all the guilt, criticism and blame that come with poverty.

"How to no money? Then let him eat dirt, and go wild" says the society.

It feels like little money which is enough to buy a piece of bread in the name of humanity. But even this small offering doesn't come freely. Poor man has to eat dirt (humiliant to get it), suffering through pain and tortures is unparalleled. The poor says that it is this pitiful and inhumane (warp) situation that he is afraid of. Poor perceives that bread, shelter and fire should be free to anybody and everybody all over the world. We must replace our machines with logic or else we will start killing one another for the sake of money.

Main problem for unhappiness and sufferings are due to the fact that we have paid and are paying more attention to material progress and comforts, ignoring life stabilizing human values. No doubt we have progressed tremendously in science and technology but lag behind in understanding ourselves and our fellow beings. We are more after love, power and wealth rather than human sympathy, understanding, affection, kindness and cooperation. Self centered attitude lead us to self destruction unless we synthesize (combining) the benefits of scientific and technological developments with life stabilizing human values. the future is bleak for man.



## 6. Babar Ali

Samayata Mukherjee Sharma

|               |                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Gleamery      |                                                         |
| Anid          | 1. amongst                                              |
| Harot         | 1. acute, extreme                                       |
| Quere         | 1. mother job                                           |
| Wadawa        | 1. hard working, a hardy                                |
| Aunoy         | 1. ingenious, earnest                                   |
| Ekagadhat     | 1. in a state of ruin, broken down                      |
| Dakh          | 1. wet, moist                                           |
| Bawa          | 1. angers, arises                                       |
| Faat          | 1. the failure, results                                 |
| Hilings       | 1. one's brethren and sisters                           |
| Detest all    | 1. more fortunate                                       |
| Despot        | 1. student who withdraws before completing a course     |
| Vamoy         | 1. pursuit                                              |
| Attensions    | 1. people who attend                                    |
| Red is spired | 1. (distorted physical abuse, beating)                  |
| Enlightened   | 1. well informed outlook                                |
| Heedless      | 1. caretakers                                           |
| Erreg         | 1. mistakes, fault                                      |
| Richety       | 1. broken down                                          |
| Toutment      | 1. witness or evidence of a fact                        |
| Quere         | 1. moving or cartooned in a positive or conflicting way |
| Commended     | 1. approved                                             |
| Anducty       | 1. daring or willingness to take bold risks             |

Comprehension I

1. Where does Bahar Ali run classes for poor children?

Bahar Ali runs classes for poor children in the backyard of his house in Masabulabad, West Bengal.

2. How is Bahar Ali's routine described by the writer?

Bahar wakes up every morning at seven and starts his day by doing some house hold chores. Then he takes an early bath, has breakfast and later walks five kilometers to his class as a student of XII.

3. Give a picture of Bahar Ali's school.

Bahar Ali's school is made up of a dilapidated concrete structure covered in half torn posters. Children study under the open blue sky. Some sit in the mud while others sit on rusty benches under a rough homemade shelter.

4. Why is Bahar Ali called 'a fortunate soul' in his village?

Bahar is called a fortunate soul in his village because unlike most children, he received formal education because he was financially supported by his father Nawazuddin Shukla.

5. What according to Bahar's father, is true religion?

According to Bahar's father Nawazuddin Shukla Education is man's true religion.

6. Why is sending children to school, a costly affair for parents?

Even families find sending children a costly affair because even though children are provided with free education, parents still have to bear the cost of uniforms and other books.

7. Tuba Rani Haque is \_\_\_\_\_

An illiterate educationalist

8. The teaching staff of Bahar Ali's school is made up of \_\_\_\_\_

High school student volunteers

9. Bahar Ali gets the children to listen by \_\_\_\_\_

Making friends with them.



## Comprehension II

10. Why do you think Bahar Ali took the initiative to start his own school?
11. What started as a game resulted in a much sought after school for the underserved? Explain.
12. Do you think that Bahar Ali's act of thoughtfulness has resulted the poor children move towards growth? Discuss.

Author Sumangita Mukherjee Sharma is the Associate Creative Editor of Youth Leader India Magazine. In her interview with Bahar Ali she says that his thoughtfulness and initiative have indeed enabled the poor and deprived children move towards growth. Bahar Ali noticed how most of his friends in his village had not received formal education. Although children were provided with free education, the parents still had to bear the cost of books and uniforms. Instead of going to school most of the boys worked as mechanics, day labourers, grass cutters, live stock handlers whereas girls worked as maid servants, cooking, cleaning, and washing clothes and dishes for their employers. So Bahar Ali wanted to bring about a change in their lives. Nasiruddin Shukh, Bahar's father a jute seller believed that education is man's true religion. So he supported his son to open a school and provided free meals for the poor students.

Bahar Ali actually started his school around 10khat Nityetan when he was nine. It grew out of a game. Bahar Ali and his friends used to play school/ school with him as a teacher. As his friends had never experienced school atmosphere they enjoyed playing as students. While they played, his friends would end up learning arithmetic and this was what led him to open his own institution for his friends and other children like them in his own village. Teaching in Ali's school is taken care of by high school student volunteers. According to Bahar Ali teaching learning process has become more effective as the generation gap is less between the teacher and the students, and this is a big advantage. Education is free and books are made available to the students. Education has become accessible, affordable and has resulted in all round development of these children. This basic education has empowered these children to aspire for higher studies and thus has opened the avenue for better jobs.

Comprehension III

1. According to Naviruddhin 'Education is man's True Religion'. How does Babar Ali's school prove this?
2. The increasing strength of Babar Ali's school reflects the transformation in our society's attitude towards education. Substantiate.
3. Do you feel that Babar Ali's initiation is a success story? Explain.

Author Sumopriya Mukherjee Sharma is the Associate Creative Editor of Youth Leader India Magazine. In her interview with Babar Ali she says that Education is a boon and this is a remarkable story of the desire to learn amid the direst (extremest) poverty. So, Ali's thoughtfulness and initiative turned an impossible mission into a possible one. Success cannot be measured by money or fame that is visible but by the positive transformation caused by a small act of courage.

The School which was started in a very humble manner in the backyard of Babar Ali's house with eight students has been transformed today to the one with eight hundred students, with 80 regular attendees and over 220 students on roll call. Anand chakrabarti Niketan consists of ten volunteer teachers teaching grade 1 to 8. It is registered with the West Bengal Government. This means that the children who gain access to education will also have more career opportunities. Text books are free from class 1 to 5. The School provides free mid-day meals and opportunity to get into the High School. Students join his School with lots of enthusiasm and interest. Moreover, they are very keen to study when a person receives education it uplifts his way of thinking and improves the quality of his life. The school has not only created confidence in young children but also enhanced self confidence of the entire villagers in this process of education. People like Yash Ranu Hanta a fishmonger, high school volunteers, Debarita Bhattacharyy, Monk at the local Rama Krishna Mission, UOI officers and local cops have participated in the school's activities which reflect their devotion towards education. In short, Babar Ali's brought has given opportunities for hundreds of deprived students.

## 7. *If I was a tree*

*Madhavadas Chennuvasamy*

### Glossary

|            |   |                                     |
|------------|---|-------------------------------------|
| Enraptured | : | trance, sleep, drowsy               |
| Enthralled | : | overpowered, polluted, spirit       |
| Disparage  | : | to look down on (a derogatory term) |
| Branch out | : | spread out, grow                    |
| Flaw       | : | weak                                |
| Hacked     | : | work, shut to pieces, chopped       |
| Bare       | : | support for burial, grave           |
| Bare       | : | scarred, sore                       |
| D. Lit     | : | Diction of letters                  |
| Anthology  | : | literary collection                 |
| Bared      | : | Hole                                |

### Comprehension (I)

#### 1. The speaker wants to be a tree because

Trees are not treated as objects of defilement.

#### 2. What wouldn't the bird ask the tree?

The bird wouldn't ask what (now) the tree belongs to before it builds its nest.

#### 3. When does the sacred cow scrape her body onto the bark?

Sacred cow scrape her body onto the bark of the tree when it felt an itch, or whenever it gets itched.

#### 4. How does the speaker want to be purified?

By burning (in the hole) for the speaker wanted to be purified.

5. The phrase 'dog-water' refers to Untouchable.
6. What word of the wood does the speaker see?

The word can be used in a holy fire for sacrifices or rituals. It also becomes the fire for a sinful dead body on the shoulders of four good men.

### Comprehension: II

1. Why would another earth not flee according to the speaker?
2. How do the life forces-sunlight and the cool breeze violate nature's idea of equality?

The poem *If I was a tree* by Madanikshi Chinnammam is a satire on social discrimination as it portrays how even a tree is treated better than a human being who belongs to the lower caste. Literally Dalit means oppressed or crushed. In earlier times, these people were made to live outside the villages and cities and their touch or even shadow was considered polluting. These groups were not entitled to education or any position of status and authority. However the sad reality is that it is still in practice in a lot of place around the country.

The poet feels that if he was a tree he would not have to face discrimination at the hands of people. The poet says if he was tree then the bird wouldn't ask for his cast before it built its nest in him, his shadow wouldn't feel defiled (polluted) if the sunlight embraced him. He further thinks that his friendship with the breeze and leaves would be sweet and sensual (lovely, pleasing).

The poet is trying to tell us that nature does not differentiate between upper and lower caste. It does not reserve its resources only for the upper caste. Fire as like the sun, the wind, water serve all human beings in the same way. It is in the name of caste and creed that man differentiates and oppresses those who come from the lower caste.

The poet feels that the sacred cow would scrape his body on the tree's bark whenever he feels the need to scratch his body and the three-hundred thousand Gods sheltering inside her would touch him as well. Even if it is cut and made into pieces it may be used to light the holy fire or used as a bier for a sinful body being carried by four good men on the shoulders.

How can someone be purified by a bath if their inner or true self is polluted.

with the idea of discriminating individuals? The point here is it is convenient to be a tree that is beyond the boundaries of caste rather than being a human being who belong to the commercial caste and suffer from caste politics.



# 8. Watchman of the Lake

H.K. Narayan

|              |   |                                   |
|--------------|---|-----------------------------------|
| Glimpse      | - | a simple village                  |
| Basic        | - | bed stone                         |
| Wrecked      | - | small person                      |
| Isolate      | - | small boat                        |
| Stun         | - | surprise                          |
| Swim         | - | stop                              |
| Office       | - | an underground room               |
| Protein      | - | meaningless talk                  |
| Gaping       | - | staring                           |
| Restrain     | - | hold back                         |
| Triumph      | - | strapped                          |
| Disappear    | - | gradually disappear               |
| Shaking      | - | quivering                         |
| Perch        | - | dry                               |
| Increasingly | - | continuously                      |
| Summit       | - | yellow                            |
| Trouse       | - | long hair                         |
| Deluge       | - | heavy rain and flood              |
| Perched      | - | the base on which a statue stands |
| Maroon       | - | small temple                      |
| Scum         | - | large number                      |

Comprehension I

1. Why was the headman in a hurry to complete the road work?

The headman was in a hurry to complete the road work because the king was supposed to arrive in the village on the next day.

2. The village headman asked Mara to keep away from the road workers because \_\_\_\_.

He was detouring the workers.

3. How did Mara manage to draw the attention of the king? Why?

Mara managed to draw the attention of the king by jumping in front of his procession from a tree. He did this to inform the king about his dream in which godhead commanded him to build the tank for river Veda.

4. The Goddess commanded to Mara was to build a tank to Veda.

5. How does the king respond to Mara's information about the tank?

The king instructed Mara to accompany him next day to his capital.

6. What does Mara advise his son in saving the lake and the creatures?

Mara advised his son to guard the lake after he is gone and deal freely with the killers and to ensure that everything which flies, swims or walks near the lake must be protected.

7. Why did the visitor approach Mara?

A visitor approached Mara to request him to help in building a few channels from the lake to his village as the crops are dying without water.

8. Mara rushed to the king because he wanted to save the lake.

9. Mara was trembling at the king's palace because

He was worried about the lake.

10. On what condition did Mara make the Goddess wait for him?

To wait until his return.

11. Why did the headman scold Mara?

Headman scolded Mara as he was sharing his vision with his neighbour.



## Comprehension II

## 11. What was the significance of Mara's dream?

R. K. Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

Mara's dream signifies the need to recognize the precious quality of water and the need to conserve water by building a tank around the river Veda, so that water will be available during summer also. In his vision the Goddess stood before him, she looked like a protective mother in every way with her tresses flying in the wind with stars in her crown, a ruby as big as the tusk of the elephant sparkling on her forehead and wearing a parure of gold. She warned that the river Veda at the foot of the hills is her own play thing, which caused sorrow for Gods and punishment for mortals. With the coming of summer the river is withdrawn into the cool glades of the mountains and people die of drought. The river yet again flows when monsoon ends. Mara, without realizing the precious quality of water, uses it as much as he wants and allows it to waste away as the food morsels he ate.

She advised Mara to tell the king to build a tank and give Veda a home and not to let her leave the village. The vision of Mara was understood by the king and he asked Mara to accompany him to the capital. The tank was built and Mara was made the watchman of the lake.

12. What instructions did Mara give his son about the lake and the creatures? What light do these instructions throw on Mara's character?

R.K. Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

Mara is more than a mere watchman of the lake. He is the custodian of the river, protector of values of nature's creation, love and selflessness. He wanted his son to possess the same values. Mara instructs his son to guard the lake after he is gone with the same outlook and deal firmly with the selfish people who come to kill the geese or the fish. Mara performs the role of the watchman of the lake with a sense of

responsibility and vision. He considers the lake as belonging to all forms of life and nobody should use it for his selfish purpose. He never allowed people to fish in the lake, or to hunt the geese which alone over the lake. He strongly believed that the lake is sacred and belongs to the goddess and according to her command no form of life should ever be killed. He performed this duty diligently. He has even let the tiger to quench its thirst. He considered himself to be the master of the lake because the king had given him the responsibility of looking after the lake, which was the result of his vision of the Goddess. He knows how much water he has to give and when to stop it. Even the herdsman has to ask for his permission if he needs water. He is the king of the Lake, and the caretaker of the lives of cattle and people. He tells his son to warn the man taking his son to the lake's edge about the depth of the lake. More willingly agrees to give water to the visitor's village where there is drought, and the crops are getting parched up and the cattle are dying. This shows that his outlook is selfless, totally involved and it is in the interest of every single person in the kingdom.

11. Bring out the significance of the sacred spot that More describes to the King.

R.K Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

The spot that More described to the king is a sacred spot. It is associated with the holy place described in 'Kamaryana'. He describes the spot as being the same scene where Lord Hanuman stood on the day Lakshmana was injured in the battle field at Lanka. The mountain whose shadow fell on the king was the same as the one on whose crest Hanuman found the vision when Sushasini, flew with it to Lanka and saved Lakshmana. A stream runs from the place, came down the mountain as Three Veda nourishing the people of the kingdom.

12. How did More react to the Goddess when she appeared before him for the first time and the second time?

R.K Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

The vision of the Gullies appears to Mats twice. In the first he saw the Gullies as the mother, a protector. Her long hair flow in the wind as she stood resplendent (bright coloured in an impressive way) before him. He was moved by her sight and bowed in reverence. He considered her words to be prophetic and repeated the same to the king who understood its significance and acted upon it by building a tank and making him its watchman.

The second vision of the Gullies was a fierce vision of warning. She appeared ferociously and her eyes glowed with a strange light. Mats was shocked and confused by her instructions to destroy the tank. He pleads with her for mercy and requests her to reconsider her decision to destroy the tank. He takes a word from the Gullies that she will not destroy the tank until he returns from the king and wishes to see the king to find a way to save the lake and preserve it for future even at the cost of sacrificing himself.

### Comprehension III

1. Was the headman justified in calling Mats a lunatic? Give reasons.

R.K. Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

The headman is a man of limited knowledge. He is rude and is interested in pleasing the king. He fails to understand the urgency of Mats to meet the king and tell his dream. He asked the workers to bind him and put him in the cellar. It was the good sense of Shama that made him escape and reach out to the king and narrate his dream which provided a perennial lake to the citizens.

2. "Nature is both protective and destructive" How does the play bring out this idea?

R.K. Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan rarely wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

Nature is universal in its prevalence throughout times. It is cyclic in its behaviour; we cannot stop or alter its natural process. Nature is both

preservative and destructive in its ways. Nature has always been kind to man in extending the resources for his well being.

In that sense, we notice how nature allows the lake to flourish and makes the entire kingdom flourish with its presence. All living beings are now taking shelter and benefit from the lake. Finally the nature sends her destructive powers to destroy the lake.

One can observe nature's fallow when it is productive and be prepared to meet disaster when it is destructive by threatening to destroy the land. The Goddess is reminding us that we do not have the power to control natural resources and determine where they should go.

1. How differently did Mara treat the fisherman and the visitor?

Or

1. Why do you think Mara asked the king to make his son, son's son and so on, the watchman of the lake?

R. K. Narayan was an Indian author whose works of fiction include a series of books about people and their interactions in an imagined town in India called Malgudi. Narayan early wrote plays and the present one is said to be a dramatized version of his short story 'The Watchman'.

Mara believes that every form of life has a right to survive in the river and man should not be selfish. He considers fishing and killing to go against this principle and warns the fisherman not to fish and remove the fish from its rightful and natural environment. He instructs his son not to allow such activities. On the other hand Mara thinks the lake has to nurture and sustain crops and cattle and the lake is not only owned by people of that region whose hot water has to be channelized to the dry land. Thus his vision is to use the Natural resources equitably and justifiably.

Mara instructs his son that he has to deal fairly with the killers and make sure that creatures of the lake are safe, when he is gone his son will have to continue the good work of watchman in the same spirit. Mara feels that it is his and his successor's duty to protect the lake and preserve it for the future because the Goddess had appeared to his vision and chose him to be the instrument through which the lake benefits the people.

## 9. The Farmer's Wife

*P. Lallinamurt (Nigeria)*

Glossary:

|              |   |                          |
|--------------|---|--------------------------|
| Heavy        | : | richness, profusion      |
| Virtuous     | : | ethical, blameless       |
| Outstretched | : | spread out               |
| Aloud        | : | physically hurt, injured |
| Revered      | : | respected                |
| Dignity      | : | self-respect, prestige   |
| Cotton-pod   | : | cotton-cotton shell      |
| Cluck        | : | clap                     |
| Articulate   | : | fluent, express clearly  |

Comprehension:

1. Who do 'you' and 'I' in the poem refer to?

You refers to the farmer.

I refers to farmer's wife.

2. Why has the speaker's husband committed suicide?

Speaker's husband committed suicide because his cotton crop failed as a result he failed to repay the debts.

3. What series of contrasts does the speaker draw between herself and her husband?

The farmer's wife contrasts how the farmer, only had to face pain and humiliation before he died, whereas she has faced it all her life. Second biggest contrast between them is that she is optimistic who chose life, whereas her husband chose death.

1. What expressions in the poem bring out the contrast between the speaker and her husband's plight? What difference does it indicate?

The farmer's wife points out that he found wisdom with poison and that poisoned her inner existence. She also says that he embraced death but she will embrace life. These contrasts indicates that the farmer is pessimist where as his wife accepts the challenges of being a lone widow and a single mother.

2. The farmer's wife in the poem is
  - a. Complaining about her husband's death
  - b. Lamenting the death of her husband
  - c. Angry that her husband has left her
  - d. Bitter about her husband's act
  - e. Worried about her future

All the above answers are correct.

3. What memories of her husband trouble her now?

The memories of her husband abusing and kicking her when he was drunk, she recalls his ill treatment and misbehavior, which troubles her now.

4. What does the phrase 'harvest of my womb' suggest? Why is their plight compared to worn out cotton pods?

The phrase 'harvest of my womb' refers to the farmer's children. Their withering is compared to worn out cotton pods as they are now left without care or nourishment from the primary earning member of the family.

5. In what condition had her husband's act of committing suicide pushed her?

The husband's suicide has left her with an outstretched hand and bent head. She is alone and without any support.

6. The poem ends with

A will to survive against all odds.

## Comprehension II

1. Many times the tone suggests the attitude of the speaker what kind of attitudes are suggested by the words 'virtuous', 'poor sinner', 'he is but a man', 'what of this?', 'why is this?'

Or

2. What kind of questions does the poem raise about the plight of farmers' widows? Do you think that these questions are only addressed to the speaker's dead husband?

A well known Telugu writer P Latha Kumar whose pen name is Vidya has been successful in bringing out the plight of a farmer's family after he committed suicide. The Farmer's wife is translated by Yaswanth Kumaraswamy from the Telugu poem 'Chavuni Kaadu Bataduni' which means 'Not Death but life'.

The poem reflects on the Farmer's wife lamenting over the death of her husband. She considers herself to be a 'sinner' as he has left them behind unable to face the creditors. The farmer is considered virtuous, as he is dead and gone. His failure to sell the crop or to lend his hand before the creditors made him put an end to himself. She says she was busy with her head and stretched for tinner. But, his wife is left behind alone to deal with all these problems. The farmer committed suicide by consuming poison, but the family will have to survive with the consequences of his decision. The destruction of the crop has lowered their dignity as also their livelihood. He found relief with the poison but that has made her situation bitter. She is disturbed with the thought of her four children.

The farmer's wife used to be treated very badly by her husband. She was abused and criticised always and often kicked by him when he was drunk. But still she tolerated all this keeping in mind he is a man. She admits she has escaped death many times in his hand, and also adds that such a death blow was something unexpected from him.

The poem is the struggle for life and the urge that the farmer's wife has to live and fight against all odds. This is necessary for the sake of her four children. She does not want to give up life as her husband did for the same reason within pride. She has a firm heart and willingness to continue life only to help her children to come up in life facing all the difficulties. Farmer suicides are indeed, a big concern. It is indeed an

act of cowardice. One must learn to cope up with life and understand that there is a solution for any problem. One must remember the amount of burden in the form of debts and the loss of earning they leave behind before going suicide.



## 10. Frederick Douglass

### Glossary:

|              |   |                               |
|--------------|---|-------------------------------|
| Assemblies   | : | Help                          |
| Conventions  | : | assembly, meeting             |
| Orator       | : | speaker                       |
| Impassive    | : | indifferent                   |
| Emancipation | : | Freedom                       |
| Accurate     | : | precise                       |
| Authentic    | : | Known to be real, genuine     |
| Deprived     | : | impoverished, underprivileged |
| Desired      | : | regret, consider              |
| Important    | : | urgent, important             |
| Withhold     | : | hold back, withhold           |
| Minor        | : | stop                          |
| Inevitable   | : | unavoidable, irreversible     |
| Field hand   | : | work in the field, farm       |
| Swelling     | : | growth, value                 |
| Telling      | : | news, information             |
| Odiousness   | : | wickedness, foulness          |
| Ordained     | : | ordered, appointed            |
| Just         | : | reasonable                    |
| Constitution | : | agreement                     |
| Sustains     | : | control                       |
| Invariably   | : | constant, consistently        |
| Obvious      | : | evident, clear                |
| Compelled    | : | forced                        |

**mean two meanings existed:**

|          |   |                                              |
|----------|---|----------------------------------------------|
| Mingus   | : | trader, dealer                               |
| Detain   | : | convinced                                    |
| Disposed | : | partial                                      |
| Melatto  | : | Child of one white parent and the other dark |
| Grey     | : | involving much bloodshed violence            |
| Previous | : | assume                                       |
| Quorum   | : | superior                                     |
| Predile  | : | innate, rusty, filthy                        |
| Black    | : | old, slow                                    |
| Unge     | : | one, hated for hitting                       |
| Humane   | : | compassionate                                |
| Slack    | : | High pitched scream, cry                     |
| Just     | : | post, support, stand                         |
| Shut     | : | silence, quiet                               |
| Barbary  | : | reckless hostility                           |

**Comprehension I:**

**1. What prevented the slaves from knowing their birthday?**

Twelve month old infants were forcefully separated from their mother before they knew, who was their mother. White masters preferred to keep their slaves ignorant about their proper age, by not maintaining any authentic records.

**2. How would the master look at the enquiries about the slaves birthday?**

The white master's deemed all enquiries about the slaves birthday as improper and impertinent.

**3. What was a lie spread about Douglass's parentage?**

It was said that the Master of Douglass, Captain Anthony himself was his father.

4. **When was Douglass separated from his mother?**

Douglass was separated from his mother when he was just twelve month old baby.

5. **Douglass mother was able to meet him only at night.**

6. **What was the penalty to the field hand for not being in the field at sunrise?**

Whipping was the penalty to the field hand for not being in the field at sunrise.

7. **How old was Douglass when he lost his mother?**

Douglass was seven years old when he lost his mother.

8. **Name the person who was believed to be both Douglass father and master.**

Captain Anthony was believed to be both Douglass father and master.

9. **What was Mr. Plummer?**

Mr. Plummer was an overseer who supervised the farms and slaves of his Master Captain Anthony. He was a miserable drunkard, profane swearer and a savage monster.

**Comprehension II**

1. **Why wasn't Douglass affected much by his mother's death?**

Frederick Douglass was born in February 1817 on the eastern shore of Maryland. His autobiographical works are *My Bondage and My Freedom* (1855) and *Life and Times of Frederick Douglass* (1901). He says that his exact date of birth remains unknown. His mother, from whom he was separated at an early age, was a slave named Harriet Bailey. She named her son Frederick Augustus Washington Bailey. He never knew exactly who his father was. He was forced to work hard and suffered cruel treatment while working on the property of Captain Aaron Anthony.

Douglass was not affected much by his mother's death because he was separated from his mother when he was just twelve months old, this was done too obviously to substantiate to slave holder's own heart, and make a gratification of their wicked designs profitable as well as pleasurable. He saw his mother hardly for four or five times in his life and each of those times was very short in duration and at night she was

lived by Mr. Stewart, who lived about twelve miles. She made her journey to see him in the night travelling the whole distance on foot, after the performance of her day's work. She was a bold hand, and a whipping was the penalty of not being in the field at sunrise. He recollects of never seeing his mother by the light of day, she was with him in the night. But long before he woke she was gone. Very little communication ever took place between them. She died when he was about seven years old, on one of his master's farms, near Lee's Mill. Frederick was not allowed to be present during her illness, at her death or burial.

### Comprehension: III.

1. What kind of hardships did the slaves suffer at the hands of the slave holder and his mistress?

(6)

2. How does the passage comment on the dreadful experience of slavery?

Frederick Douglass was born in February 1817 on the eastern shore of Maryland. His autobiographical works are *My Bondage and My Freedom* (1875) and *Life and Times of Frederick Douglass* (1881).

His mother, from whom he was separated at an early age, was a slave named Harriet Bailey. She named her son Frederick Augustus Washington Bailey. He never knew exactly who his father was. He was forced to work hard and suffered cruel treatment while working on the property of Captain Aaron Anthony.

The hardships faced by the slaves at the hands of the slave holder and their mistress were unexplainable. They were not allowed to know their ages or about their parents. Infants were separated from their slave mother before they knew she was their mother.

The slave holders were inhuman and showed extraordinary barbarity in dealing with the slaves. They would at times even go to take great pleasure in whipping a slave. Mr. Anthony, the slave holder and his overseer, Mr. Plummer who was a miserable drunkard, profane swearer and a savage monster, always went around armed with a cow skin and a heavy whip.

He used to cut and slash the women's heads so horribly, that even master would be enraged at his cruelty. Malatta spoken with one black

parent and one white parent) children were the great sufferers. They were in the first place, a constant offence to their mistress. She was ever disposed to find fault with them; they could seldom do anything to please her; she was never better pleased than when she saw them under the lash, especially when she suspected her husband of showing to his mulatto children lessons which he withheld from his black slaves. The master was frequently compelled to sell this class of his slaves, out of deference to the feelings of his white wife, and cruel as the deed may strike any one to be, for a man to sell his own children to human flesh-mongers, it was often the dictate of economy for him to do so; for, unless he did this he must not only whip them himself, but must stand by and see one white son tie up his brother, of but few shades darker complexion than himself, and ply the pory lash to his naked back; and if he looked one word of disapproval, it was set down to his parental partiality, and only made a bad matter worse both for himself and the slave whom he would protect and defend.

1. In spite of the hardships he suffered as a slave, why does the author say, "Slavery would not always be able to hold me within its foul embrace?"

Frederick Douglass was born in February 1817 in the master's class of Maryland. His autobiographical works are *My Bondage and My Freedom* (1855) and *Life and Times of Frederick Douglass* (1881). His exact date of birth remains unknown. His mother, from whom he was separated at an early age, was a slave named Harriet Bailey. She named her son Frederick Augustus Washington Bailey. He never knew exactly who his father was. He was forced to work hard and suffered cruel treatment while working on the property of Captain Aaron Anthony.

The hardships faced by the slaves at the hands of the slave holder and their mistress were unexplainable. They were not allowed to know their age or about their parents. Infants were separated from their slave mother before they knew she was their mother. The slave holders were infamous and showed extraordinary harshness in dealing with the slaves. They would at times seem to take great pleasure in whipping a slave.

Mr. Anthony, the slave holder and his overseer, Mr. Plummer who was a miserable drunkard, profligate owner and a savage monster who always

went around armed with a cow skin and a heavy cudgel. He used to cut and slash the women's heads so heavily, that even master would be outraged at his cruelty.

The author expresses his dreadful childhood. Experience of slavery as how he was a witness of the scene of the day by the most heart rending shrieks of his aunt, who was whipped by her master till she was bloodily covered with blood? No words, no tears, no prayers from the victim seemed to move the iron heart, the harder she screamed the harder he whipped and where the blood ran fastest, there he whipped longest. He would whip her to make screams and whip her to make her bleed.

In spite of the hardships, he suffered as a slave, he firmly believed in God. Even in the darkest hours of his career in slavery, the living word of faith and spirit of hope did not depart from him. His optimism showed light at the end of the tunnel, hence he has a deep conviction that slavery would not always hold him, within its cruel embrace.

## 11. An Old Woman

Arvo Kallikott

### Glossary

|                 |   |                                                              |
|-----------------|---|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tag             | = | follow closely                                               |
| Boat            | = | have his/her company somewhere                               |
| Fare            | = | fare                                                         |
| Wretched        | = | miserable                                                    |
| Crone           | = | an ugly old woman                                            |
| Clatter         | = | the sound of the hard objects                                |
| Air of finality | = | the impression that there is nothing more to be said or done |
| Flint glass     | = | glass of fine quality used for dinner, mirrors.              |

### COMPREHENSION 1

1. 'You' in the poem refers to the speaker.
2. What does the old woman offer to do?  
The old woman offers to be a tourist guide.
3. What does she expect for her service?  
She expects fifty pence coin for her service.
4. The lines, 'You turn around and fare her with an air of finality' suggest that he decided to end the fare.
5. The old woman's eyes are compared to halcyon huts.
6. 'You are reduced to so much small change in her hand'  
Here, the speaker is suggesting that  
C. One loses a change in one's personality.

COMPREHENSION II

1. How is the plight of the old woman depicted in the poem?

Amos Kulkarni is a bilingual poet. *An Old Woman* is selected from *Amos*, a collection his of poems. The old woman he has tried to create is the one who represents our culture, our heritage and our natural beauty. Initially it seems that she is little reluctant when speaker refuses to give her any money. But, it also shows how she does not resolve to beggary. She wishes to take the speaker to the house she shares; in return she demands a mere fifty paisa coin.

Poverty and old age are two curses that can cripple a person and make him utterly helpless. The old woman is shown as a helpless woman who laments saying "What else can an Old Woman do on hills as worned as I am?"

2. The Old Woman in the poem is a self appointed tourist guide, not a beggar. Do you agree? Give reasons.

Amos Kulkarni is a bilingual poet. *An Old Woman* is selected from *Amos*, a collection his of poems. Yes, I agree that the old woman is a self appointed tourist guide and not a beggar. She is asking a fifty paisa coin in return for taking the speaker round the House-Share House. This shows that she does not want to beg but wants to earn her living in the only way she knew. She appears happy to receive wages after having the visitor to get her guidance about the place.

3. How does the Speaker's attitude undergo a change?

Amos Kulkarni is a bilingual poet. *An Old Woman* is taken from *Amos*, a collection of his poems. The old woman he has tried to create is the one who represents our culture, our heritage and our natural beauty. Initially it seems that she is little reluctant when speaker refuses to give her any money. But, it also shows how she does not resolve to beggary. She wishes to take the speaker to the house she shares; in return she demands a mere fifty paisa coin.

Poverty and old age are two curses that can cripple a person and make him utterly helpless. The old woman is shown as a helpless woman who laments saying "What else can an Old Woman do on hills as worned as I am?"

The Speaker looks into her eyes and realises she is right. Her helplessness because of her old age moves him. He is also touched by the



fact that she wants to earn the fifty paise coin by showing him the house she shares rather than demanding it as a charity. All this brings about a change in his approach and attitude.

### COMPREHENSION III

1. "The Old Woman refuses the self-esteem of the speaker and makes him feel that he is nothing more than 'so much small change'. Comment."

Arun Kolarkar is a bilingual Poet. An Old Woman is taken from Jyoti, a collection of his poems. The old woman he has tried to create is the one who represents our culture, our heritage and our natural beauty. Initially it seems that she is little ashamed when speaker refuses to give her any money. But, it also shows how she does not resolve in beggary. She wishes to take the speaker to the house she shares; in return she demands a mere fifty paise coin.

Poverty and old age are two reasons that can cripple a person and make him utterly helpless. The old woman is shown as a helpless woman (he himself is saying, "What else was an Old Woman doing hills so wretched as these?") The Speaker looks into her eyes and realises she is right. Her helplessness because of her old age moves him. He is also touched by the fact that she wants to earn the fifty paise coin by showing him the house she shares rather than demanding it as a charity.

All this brings about a change in his approach and attitude. Thus an arrogant, unconvicted tourist is moved by the self-esteem of an old woman. Initially, he tries to ignore her by going back to whatever she said and by claiming that he has already seen the shrine he wanted to escape from her clutches. The woman persists him to give her that little job, so that she can earn a bit to fill her stomach. Her willingness to work for a living has reduced him to the small change in her hands.

2. What is the Speaker trying to convey through the lines 'and the hills crack, and the temples crack, and the sky falls'?

Arun Kolarkar is a bilingual Poet. An Old Woman is taken from Jyoti, a collection of his poems. The old woman he has tried to create is the one who represents our culture, our heritage and our natural beauty. The speaker highlights the fact that growing old is not just for the living being it also applies to the non-living forms like the hills and the temples. Cracks are simply a sign of old age. It is a natural process that

with the passage of time, the hills and temples which were strong earlier develop cracks. Everything around the poet seems to fall at the attitude carried by the old woman. Her willingness to survive with dignity in those weathered hills at that age causes the hills and the temples to crack and the sky to fall.

1. How do you relate the 'cracks around her eyes' to the cracking of hills and temples?

Anita Lalitha is a bilingual poet. *An Old Woman* is taken from *Jejuri*, a collection of her poems. 'Cracks' are simply a sign of old age. Age is an important factor. As the age passes by it starts leaving its ugly impact on the body. With the passage of time even the hills and temples which were strong earlier develop cracks. It is a natural process. The 'cracks around her eyes' are symbolic of her old age and rich experiences. It also talks about the wisdom that comes with age. The hills and temples represent the same wisdom and dignity that a woman stands for. The old woman and the hills have been around for centuries. Despite of being old the woman is able to carry on and find means to keep her life going just like the hills and the temples.

## 12. Two Gentlemen of Verona

A.J. Cronin

|             |                                        |
|-------------|----------------------------------------|
| Glossary    |                                        |
| Outskirts   | the borders of a town                  |
| Scarlet     | red                                    |
| Tangled     | intently                               |
| Exquisite   | very beautiful                         |
| Downy about | come to a halt                         |
| Perched     | stood, sat                             |
| Unswerving  | never failing                          |
| Run errands | did small jobs for others              |
| Exports     | leave one's country and sell elsewhere |
| Baffle      | confused                               |
| Piped up    | high pitched voice of a child          |
| Gloating    | stom. angrily                          |
| Vexation    | worry, annoyance                       |
| Personage   | someone, charming way                  |
| Yield       | high tone                              |
| Contentment | happy, satisfied                       |

### COMPREHENSION: 1

#### 1. Where does the narrative first meet the two boys?

The narrative first meets the two boys on the outskirts of Verona.

#### 2. Why doesn't the driver approve of the narrative buying fruit from the two boys? Does he agree?

The driver doesn't approve of the narrative buying fruit from the two boys because of their chubby appearance and dissatisfied that one was

got better food in Vermont. He does not succeed because neither felt himself being strongly attracted towards these two children. So he bought them biggest basket, then set off towards the town.

1. List the different things that the boys did to earn their living.

The boys did different things to earn their living and they were as follows: Phoned doors, sold fruits, hawked newspapers, acted as tourists guide and ran errands and exploited every avenue for their living.

4. In spite of working hard and earning money the two boys still lacked peace because

C. Wanted to save the money for medical expenses.

5. What qualities in the two boys attracted the narrator?

The qualities in the two boys that attracted the narrator were their unswerving willingness to do any work, their polite, serious mannerism, helping nature, and extraordinary courage and indomitable spirit to survive against all odds.

8. Nicole was not pleased when Jaroop asked the narrator to drive them to Peoria as he

C. did not want to ask anyone for favour.

1. Why did the two boys go to Peoria and Why did they want the narrator not to follow them?

The two boys went to Peoria every Sunday to meet their ailing sister Lucia. They wanted the narrator not to follow them because they wanted to have their own secrets.

8. The narrator did not follow the boys because

C. He wanted to respect their privacy.

8. What had made the two boys and their sister homeless?

The two boys and their sister had been made homeless because a bomb had destroyed their home.

10. The author did not speak to the boys on their return journey because he thought

a. The boys would prefer to keep their secret.

## 11. What does the narrative learn from Lucia's nurse?

Lucia's nurse reveals a lot of unbelievable secrets of those two young boys. They lost their father, a widower in the war and then a band had destroyed their house. This left them on the streets and made them slaves and exposed to the cold Yunnan winter. Very soon, they built a sort of shelter with their own hands amidst the rubble. They worked in the underground restaurant in German rule in Yunnan. They had immense knowledge of the neighboring hills and this made them immensely valuable. They risked their lives many times for peace. When they got back the peace, they found that Lucia was suffering from tuberculosis of spine contracted during the miseries of the war. They never gave up. She was brought to the hospital and for the past 12 months, she is the patient there. Lucia had been making progress and the nurse says that there was hope that she would walk and sing one day. Every week Lucia's landlady had made their payments but she's unable to explain how they did it.

## COMPREHENSION II

## 1. In what different ways were the boys useful to the narrator?

A. J. Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The Keys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

The narrator met the two brothers: Nicola, thirteen-year-old and Jacopo, twelve-year-old on the outskirts of Yunnan when they were selling strawberries. Impressed by their appearance, the narrator bought fruit from them. In the days that followed the narrator discovered that these boys did a lot of other things apart from selling fruits. They sold newspapers, they polished shoes, and they worked as guides to tourists and ran errands. The boys proved to be extremely useful to the narrator. Whenever they wanted a pack of American cigarettes or seats for the opera or the name of a good restaurant that could provide revells, they satisfied their needs with their usual cheerful competence.

1. What do you understand about the boy's character from their action and behavior?

A. J. Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The Keys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

Nicola is a thirteen year old boy whose younger brother Jacopo is just twelve. The hardship in life has made the boys very mature for their age. They work selflessly and tirelessly for the treatment of their sister, Lucia who was suffering from tuberculosis of spine. They are shabby in their dress and live on black bread and figs, but kept their sister in an expensive hospital to get the best of care.

The boys were very friendly and innocent but beneath their cheerful smile some sadness was hidden. Their eagerness to do any work was really remarkable. The boys appear to be cheerful, polite, well-mannered and compassionate. They also have a lot of self-respect. They are extremely hardworking and matured in their outlook. They do not want to gain sympathy from the people by narrating their personal tragedy. They appear to be very caring and considerate brothers.

### COMPREHENSION III

1. Do you think the ending comes to you as a surprise? Why?

A. J. Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The Keys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

Yes, the ending comes as a surprise. In the initial part of the story it appears that these boys are working hard for money only. As the narrative continues we get to understand that the boys are more than just the street vendors. They appear to be men of hard work and of high self-respect. Their love for their sick sister Lucia and willingness to take up any job cheerfully at that age really surprises everyone. Nicola is a thirteen year old boy whose younger brother Jacopo is just twelve. The

hardship in life has made the boys very mature for their age. They work selflessly and tirelessly for the treatment of their sister, Lucia who was suffering from tuberculosis of spine. There are shabby, in their shoes and low on black bread and figs, but kept their sister in an expensive hospital to get the best of care.

2. Had you been in the place of the narrator would you have behaved differently?

A J Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The boys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

If I was in the place of the narrator, I guess I would have behaved differently towards the two young boys. After learning about their personal tragedy and sister's ailment, one could develop sympathy and render a helping hand. Whereas the narrator did not do any of those, in order to respect their privacy and self-esteem.

3. "Appearances are Deceptive". How does the story bring out this idea?

A J Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The boys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

*Appearances are deceptive*; they need not reveal the character of a person. Nicola and Jacopo initially were seen dressed shabbily selling strawberries. Despite of their appearances, the author bought fruit from them. The narrator realises that the boys did a lot of other things apart from selling their berries in the days that followed. They sold newspapers, polished shoes, worked as Guides to the tourists and many more. The author discovers a sense of purpose and self-esteem that was beyond their age. Despite their appearances they never derived a love or pity from anyone. They earned a living for themselves and provided medical assistance to their ailing sister Lucia at the behest of the Hospital.

4. What may destroy one's home but not one's heart? Discuss the statement.

A. J. Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The Keys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

With reference to the story of the two boys, despite of the trouble and the loss caused by the war, the boys were able to cheerfully carry on with their tasks. They had to help Lucia, their sister to recover from her illness, they did it with more enthusiasm. The war had destroyed everything, starting from their father and then their home. Later on they discover that their sister is suffering from TB of spine. They are orphaned, homeless and still young. They choose to lead a life of dignity. Until the war they had led a comfortable life. War had thrown them to the streets, exposing them to bitter cold and extreme starvation. The destruction caused by the war had not broken their spirits. Their courage, devotion and maturity bring in new hope for themselves. They are able to cheerfully carry on with their lives and add meaning to it.

5. Do you think the story is telling a comment on the true character of gentleman's behaviour?

A. J. Cronin (1896-1981) was Scottish novelist and Physician. Cronin wrote his first novel *Hatter's Castle*. This was such a great success that he gave up medicine to pursue literature. He wrote several novels like 'The Keys of the Kingdom', 'The Spanish Gardener' etc. His works have been translated into many languages and several of his books have been filmed.

The story is definitely telling a comment on the true character of a gentleman, because the two small boys have all the qualities of a true gentleman. At that young age, they behave in a perfectly matured way. They are polite, sensitive and compassionate. They do not want to trouble or bother others about their problems. They never complain about their past and are ever smiling.



# 13. Do not ask of Me, My Love

*First Abroad Poem*

Glossary

|          |   |                                                |
|----------|---|------------------------------------------------|
| Vain     | : | useless, empty                                 |
| Blissful | : | (imaginary) joy (idea or belief that is false) |
| Brutal   | : | cruel, harsh                                   |
| Showered | : | exposed to                                     |
| Enduring | : | immortal                                       |

## Comprehension I

1. When does the speaker realize what he thought about love was not true?

The speaker realized what he thought about love was not true, when he came to know that there were other women in the world than love and other pleasures.

2. That's the way I imagined it to be' suggests

A) That the speaker's concept of love is naive

3. For there are other women in the world than love'. here women refers to miseries

B) Caused by poverty and deprivation.

4. You are beautiful still, My love' Here the speaker is expressing his

A) Fidelity to his love.

## Comprehension II

1. What does the line 'these dark and brutal cruelties of countless centuries' suggest?
2. What harsh realities of life have drawn the speaker's attention much more than the beauty of his beloved?

1. What transformation in the perception of love do you see in the poem?

Fazl-Muhammad Fazl is famous Urdu poet from Pakistan; native about the love of a man which was thought to be lasting forever. But, very soon there is a transformation and realizes that there are much more gloominess and sorrow in the world than love. The refrain 'Do not ask of me, my love that love I once had for you' tells us about his awareness of other realities of life.

In the first stanza the poet reflects the earlier love of a man and his love. Life was assumed to be bright, young and blossoming. The woman of his love was painful than any other pain. There was a time when he considered that her beauty added on to the beauty of spring and gave it an everlasting youth. He used to conclude that her eyes scattered stars and everything else was a waste. In her presence, he would assume that the whole world was his. But soon he realizes it was merely an illusion. The love that he thought was all powerful and consuming was just one more of the many pains and pleasures in the world.

The next stanza speaks about the harsh realities of life. He begins to see the realities that consumed him and glazes with his love yet is ask for the same love he had for her. He realizes the sufferings of humanity. He understands his mistake in seeing his beloved's pain as that greatest. The more he drifts away from his love, the better he is capable of understanding the meaning of true love.

Love can be woven in silk, cotton and threads but brutality of the crimes that mankind has suffered for primitive questions this entire of time. The poet points out instances of war and bloodshed, the human trafficking the diseases and fearful beliefs of human beings that has infected the world, with the wounds festering. When there is injustice and starvation poverty and deprivation, the poet feels he is not capable of involving himself into his past love. The poet concludes that he is helpless even though the lover is still beautiful, there are other sorrows and pleasures in the world more than love. He comes to the conclusion of being more considerate towards others problems and sufferings.

# First Year PUC Annual Examination,

February/ March - 2014

Time : 3 Hours 15 Min.

Max. Marks : 100

1. Answer the following in a word a phrase or a sentence each :

12 x 1 = 12

1. Who was appointed as the chairman of the Commission?
2. How does the speaker sit in the school in the poem "The school boy"?
3. \_\_\_\_\_ found Kipling's of his poem in "Around a Medical camp?"  
a) Mary    b) Whitman    c) Malher's mother
4. Whom did the narrators teach to write their addresses in English in "Oya Hasmakyan"?
5. What is the collective madness according to the speaker in "Money madness"?
6. Name Babar Ali's school.
7. Where are the three hundred thousand girls sheltered in "If I was a tree"?
8. What does the Gulliver refer to as a play thing in "Watchman of the lake"?
9. Mention the age at which the children of the slaves were separated from their mothers.
10. Whom does the old woman want to take the speaker in the poem "An old woman"?
11. Who abused the speaker in the poem "The Farmer's wife"?
12. Whom did Joseph and Nicola go every Sunday?

may not necessarily occur.

II. Answer any eight of the following in a paragraph of 80-100 words

each:

8 x 8 = 64

11. The railway commission did not give justice to man explain the statement with reference to "The Gentleman of the Jungle".
12. Why is the boy disappointed to go school?
13. Narrate one of the interesting stories told by Maya in "Armed a mechanical toy?"
14. Describe the humiliation felt by the narrator in the restaurant in "see Mamasan?"
15. What are the instructions that Maya gives his son regarding the lake in "Watchman of the Lake"?
16. What other movies and persons call for the poet's attention in "Do not ask of me my love"?
17. Write a note on the difficulties faced by illiterate children in Frederick Douglass.
18. Explain the impact of war on Lucia's life in "Two gentlemen of Verona".
19. How does the farmer's wife bring out the dehumanisation of the woman to survive?
20. How does the poet reveal that the things in nature do not make any discrimination like human beings in "It was a tree".

III. Answer one of the following in about 200 words:

1 x 6 = 6

21. Before Ali's thoughtfulness brought a change in lives of many underprivileged children. Explain.

OR

How does Maya sacrifice his life for the village in "Watchman of the Lake".

OR

Describe the importance of money with reference to "Money madness".

## IV. Read the following passage and answer the questions set on it.

10

Pineapple one of the popular tropical fruits is widely cultivated in south India, Assam and other Himalayan states. It is one of the rare fruits that can be grown in shade preferably under mango trees. The plant grows widely almost in any soil and does not require much care.

The shoots of the plants reach maturity within a short span of time. It takes 11 to 27 months for the plant to bear fruit. The fruit possesses a wonderful taste and an excellent flavour. In America some of the farmers are producing fibrous variety. One type of pineapple is almost without any core.

Pineapple has Medicinal values. It contains an enzyme called Bromelain that helps the body digest protein and fats. So, Pineapple juice along with the meals is recommended for people suffering from indigestion. Fresh pineapple juice relieves thirst and soothes the throat, especially the vocal cords. So it is a valuable tonic for singers. Another chemical product of pineapple is chlorine that combats the kidney infection, a disease causing water fluid collecting in the body. Pineapple juice is helpful in relieving jaundice and strengthening the liver. In diabetes pineapple juice relieves the acidity and irritability condition of the throat. If the juice is very sour should add honey instead of sugar to improve the taste properties.

24. Which type of fruit is pineapple?
25. What is the quality of pineapple?
26. How much time does the pineapple plant take to bear fruit?
27. Which variety of pineapple is grown in Assam?
28. Who are recommended to take pineapple juice along with the meals?
29. Which is the enzyme that helps the body to digest protein and fats?
30. What is chlorine?
31. \_\_\_\_\_ is a disease causing water fluid collecting in the body.  
a) diabetes      b) dengue      c) diphtheria
32. Add prefix to the word 'digestion' to make an antonym of the word.
33. Write the word which means 'body' from the passage.

www.thetestpage.com

V. A. Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles and prepositions given in brackets. (1 x 4 = 4)

14. Call Sumana by \_\_\_\_\_ whenever go \_\_\_\_\_ a herd of  
dreams and romance \_\_\_\_\_ all people in my kingdom that. This is  
the last day of \_\_\_\_\_ world.

(a, to, on, with, the, for)

B. Fill in the blanks with the suitable form of the verb given in  
brackets. (1 x 4 = 4)

15. I am Krishna looking for the medicinal creeper, when I \_\_\_\_\_ (listen) to  
his description, I \_\_\_\_\_ that once that he was looking for the same  
creeper which Mary and Appanna \_\_\_\_\_ (have) visit to the nearest town. I  
\_\_\_\_\_ (take) him to the plant.

C. Choose the correct form of the verb that agrees with the subject. (1 x 3 = 3)

16. The travelling crew of nine \_\_\_\_\_ (is / are) made of high school student  
volunteers. They \_\_\_\_\_ (is / are) teenagers. One of the teachers  
Debarita \_\_\_\_\_ (go / goes / to) college in Dehradun.

D. Convert the following sentences and rewrite them. (2 x 1 = 2)

17. A Cellar used bed has to be protected from a rat.

18. Why you are so late, Nanda?

E. Re-Write as directed. (1 x 1 = 1)

19. I have another \_\_\_\_\_ (space) piece of work for you.

(Fill in the blank with appropriate word given in brackets)

20. Some plants are \_\_\_\_\_ (poison)

(complete the sentence with the right form of the word given in  
brackets)

21. treated as / a / was / Mary / Mad man.

(Re-arrange the segments to form a meaningful sentence)

22. Varanasi is a lovely city \_\_\_\_\_ (Add a question tag)

23. The teacher gave us home work.

(Change into a question beginning with the right form of 'do')

42. The highlight path lets track inside the text slowly.

(Frame a question as a to get the underlined word as an answer)

VI. A. Refer to the following list of events and answer the questions set on it. (3x3=9)

| Annual sports Meet |            |                   |
|--------------------|------------|-------------------|
| Events             | Date       | Time              |
| Inauguration       | 12-01-2014 | 8 a.m. to 10 a.m. |
| Sports Activities  | 13-02-2014 | 11 a.m. to 2 p.m. |
| Indoor games       | 12-02-2014 | 3 p.m. to 5 p.m.  |
| Group games        |            |                   |
| Raceable           | 13-02-2014 | 8 a.m. to 11 a.m. |
| Volley ball        | 13-02-2014 | 2 p.m. to 4 p.m.  |

43. i) Mention the name of the function?

ii) At what time does the inauguration of the programme starts?

iii) Where are the indoor games conducted?

iv) Which is the group game conducted on 13-02-2014 in the morning?

48. Write a letter to the Principal of your college requesting to permit to attend the District level cultural competitions to be held in Bharwad. Your letter should contain the following points. (3x3=9)

\*Date and time of programme

\*Venue of the programme.

VII. A) Match the expression under column A to its corresponding language.

which are categorically assessed.

Functions under B

Ex 5-5

47.

A

B

Expressions

Functions

1. Oh, God! How sad?

Greeting

2. Hello, good morning

Greeting

3. I am grateful to you

Offering to help

4. Goodbye

Expressing sympathy

5. Can I help

Leave-taking

48. Complete the dialogue.

Ex 5-6

Miss Yvonne: Good morning miss Helen.

Miss Helen: \_\_\_\_\_

Miss Yvonne: How are you?

Miss Helen: very well \_\_\_\_\_

Miss Yvonne: I think we've not met for a long time.

Miss Helen: Yes, I was with my mother.

Miss Yvonne: \_\_\_\_\_, I need to go home now, see you.

Miss Helen: \_\_\_\_\_ Yvonne.

49. Dialogue writing.

5

Your friend has won the first prize in the District level Essay competition. Write a Dialogue Congratulating your friend.

First PUC Annual Examination, February - 2013



Time: 3 Hours 15 Min.

Max. Marks : 100

**Instructions:**

- Follow the prescribed form while answering the questions.
  - Write the correct question number as it appears on the question paper.
  - One mark questions attempted more than once will be awarded zero.
  - For multiple choice questions choose the correct answer and rewrite it.
1. Answer the following in a word, a phrase or a sentence each :  
[x 12] 12
- Why would peace and tranquility in the story 'The Gentlemen of the Jungle'?
  - What drives away the joy of the school boy?
  - Krishna, in several medicinal respects was suffering from  
a) head pain                      b) piles                      c) neck pain
  - Who did the narrator wish to write their address in English in 'Our Handicraft'?
  - What has one to eat, if one doesn't have money, according to the poet in the 'Money Madman'?
  - Name the woman who helps Balraj Ali in sending children to his school in the story 'Balraj Ali'.
  - Mary requested the king to give :  
a) The King  
b) The lake  
c) his own life
  - How old was Douglas when he lost his mother in the story, 'Ferdinand Douglas'?
  - Whom does the old woman wish to take the pilgrim if he possibly takes care to her in 'An old woman'?
  - Who informs the narrator about Lucia's family in 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'?
  - Why does the Farmer's wife tolerate her husband in 'Farmer's wife'?

answer one question only.

11. What was more useful than love to the poet, in the poem, 'Don't ask of me, my love'?
12. Answer any Eight of the following choosing at least two from poems in paragraphs of 80-100 words each : 4 x 8 = 32
13. Why were the commissioners of enquiry appointed by the king of the Jungle in 'The Gentlemen of the Jungle'?
14. Describe the boy's experience in the school in the poem 'The School Boy'.
15. What was the story behind Mata's loss of tooth on right side in 'Armed Medical Creepers'?
16. How did a stranger save the day for the narrator in 'Vita Manichaeum'? Explain.
17. Give an account of the meeting that took place between Mata and the king on the stormy night.
18. How does the poem, 'The Farmer's Wife' bring out the plight of the woman?
19. Why did Frederick Douglass and other slaves feel depressed as they could not tell their age?
20. Describe an old woman's role as a guide in the poem, 'An Old Woman'.
21. What makes Koots and Jacque gentlemen of Verona?
22. What change is noticed in the attitude of the speaker towards his beloved in the poem, 'Don't ask of me, my love'?
23. Answer one of the following in about 200 words : 1 x 6 = 6
24. Bakht Ali's school is very different from other formal schools. Discuss.

OR

How does the poem, 'If I were A Tree' bring out the social discrimination in the society?

OR

Describe about Mata's commitment shown towards living beings in 'The watchman of the lake'.

IV. Read the following passage and answer the questions set on it.

Our forests are important sources covering one fifth of the country's land area. They supply the timber for the railways, house building and furniture making. They also supply the pulp for making and the bamboo for paper making. Medicinal herbs also come from the forests.

In the olden days our sages and philosophers had their Ashrams in the forests. These Ashrams were centres of knowledge and learning. Unfortunately forests were ruthlessly cut down in the past few years. While the forests are disappearing, the demand for timber is growing. We must, therefore protect and develop our forests. Vana Mahotsava is an important step in this direction. It is observed for a week in July every year. During this week, lakhs of saplings are planted throughout the country. This is being done to restore our fast disappearing forests.

24. For what purpose do we need timber?
25. What do forests supply for paper making?
26. What did our Wise men and philosophers do in the forests?
27. What was the use of Ashrams?
28. What was unfortunate about the forests in the past few years?
29. When is Vana Mahotsava observed?
30. What is done during the Vana Mahotsava?
31. Why is Vana Mahotsava celebrated?
32. Our wise men and philosophers had Ashrams in \_\_\_\_\_.

(Fill in the blank with right word from (b) passage.)

33. Forests are important sources of natural wealth covering one \_\_\_\_\_ of the country's land area.  
a) sixth      b) fourth      c) fifth

- V. A) Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles and prepositions given in brackets. 4 x 1 = 4

34. Krishna knew \_\_\_\_\_ Malayali. So, he \_\_\_\_\_ had treated Krishna on \_\_\_\_\_ earlier occasion, when Krishna had started developing boils \_\_\_\_\_ his body. The gubans had given \_\_\_\_\_ Krishna the back \_\_\_\_\_ some time.  
(a) a, the, once, at

- B) Fill in the blanks with the suitable form of the verbs given in

show the appropriate tense(s). \_\_\_\_\_  
bracket(s). \_\_\_\_\_ (x1=1)

25. The narrator put his hand in his coat pocket to get it. He \_\_\_\_\_, began  
sweating profusely and almost \_\_\_\_\_ (sighs) in an instant all that  
he \_\_\_\_\_ (survived). The reason \_\_\_\_\_ (say) his wallet was not there.  
C) Choose the correct form of the Verbs that agree with the subjects.

(x1=2)

26. Every modern plant \_\_\_\_\_ (have / has) healing power. But for some  
strange reason, the modern world \_\_\_\_\_ (does / do) not possess this  
precious knowledge. As it is on the verge of extinction.

D) Correct the following sentences and rewrite them. \_\_\_\_\_ (x1=2)

27. I am liking English very much.

28. This is a best thing.

E) Rewrite as directed. \_\_\_\_\_ (x1=4)

29. The thief has been released in \_\_\_\_\_ (do / don't).

(Fill in the blank with appropriate word given in bracket.)

30. Babar Ali provides free \_\_\_\_\_ (educate) to all the poor students in his  
native place.

(Fill in the blank by adding a suitable suffix to the word given in  
bracket.)

31. in / like / Bengali in / now

(Rearrange the segments to form a meaningful sentence.)

32. Jacques is lively as a squirrel. (Add a question tag.)

33. Manu requested the king to build a lake.

(Change into a question beginning with the right form of 'do')

34. Vaidya wrote the Ramayana.

(Form a question so as to get the underlined word as an answer.)

VLA. Refer to the following list of events and answer the questions set on:

8.

1 x 4 = 4

| Event               | Time                     |
|---------------------|--------------------------|
| Inaugural           | 10.00 a.m. to 11.00 a.m. |
| Prize distribution  | 11.00 a.m. to 12.00 p.m. |
| Cultural programmes |                          |
| Songs and dances    | 12.30 p.m. to 1.00 p.m.  |
| Lunch break         | 2.00 p.m. to 2.30 p.m.   |
| Drama               | 3.00 p.m. to 4.00 p.m.   |

43. i) How long will the inaugural event last?  
 ii) When will the prize distribution begin?  
 iii) When will the cultural programmes take place?  
 iv) What is the time allotted for drama?
44. Write a letter to the Commissioner, City Corporation, Riversprings, Mysore complaining irregular water supply in your locality. Your letter should include the following points.
- \* Irregular water supply and the areas affected
  - \* Interference caused to the general public

VII. A) Match the expression under column 'A' to its corresponding Language function under 'B'

2 x 1 = 2

| A                                    | B                          |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Expressions                          | Functions                  |
| 1. Hello, good morning               | a) Expressing gratitude    |
| 2. Meet my friend Davi               | b) Greeting                |
| 3. Could you please pass me the bag? | c) Expressing co-operation |
| 4. Thank you so much                 | d) Requesting              |
| 5. Oh, God! How sad!                 | e) Introducing             |

B) 48. Complete the dialogue.

2x1=2

- David: Hello, Ravi. \_\_\_\_\_?  
 Ravi: \_\_\_\_\_, How do you do?  
 David: I am ok.  
 Ravi: Oh! You are wearing a jacket. Now \_\_\_\_\_?  
 David: No, \_\_\_\_\_.

C) 49. Dialogue Writing.

2x1=2

David has won the championship at the District Level athletic meet. His friend Manish compliments him. Write a dialogue between David and Manish.

First PGC Annual Examination, February - 2004

Time: 1 Hour 15 Min

Max. Marks: 100

Instructions:

1. Follow the prescribed limit while answering questions.
  2. Write the correct question numbers as it appears on the question paper.
  3. One mark questions attempted more than once will be awarded zero.
  4. For multiple choice questions choose the correct answer and rewrite.
- Answer the following questions in a word, a phrase or in a sentence each. (2x11=22)
1. Who accused Justice to mean in the lesson, "The Gentlemen of the Jungle"?
  2. Which bird sings with the boy in the poem "The School Boy"?
  3. Who lost the tooth in the lesson, "Animal's Medical Creep"?
  4. At what time did the narrator wake up in the lesson "On a Mammochy"?
  5. According to the poet what is everyone's mission in "Money Madness"?
  6. Name Babat Ali's father in the lesson, "Babat Ali".
  7. What wouldn't the bird ask the rose in the poem, "If I was a tree"?
  8. Where did the Headman contract to guard Hari in the lesson, "Watchman of the lake"?
  9. Whom does "You" refer to in the poem "The Farmer's Wife"?
  10. Where was Frederick Douglass born?
  11. What does an Old woman expect for her services in the poem "An Old woman"?
  12. Where did the two boys meet the narrator in the lesson, "Two Gentlemen of Verona"?

max 200 characters remain

II. Answer any Eight of the following choosing at least Two from poetry to a paragraph of 80-100 words each. 8x4=32

13. Do you agree with the action of the man at the end of the story, "The Gentlemen of the Jungle"? Why?
14. How does the poet argue against formal schooling in the poem "The School Boy"? Explain.
15. How was Krishna proud of his illness?
16. Give an account of the Eshwaraming experience faced by the narrator in "Dev. Manoharan".
17. How does money trigger fear in an individual in "Money Madness"?
18. How do you justify the poem, "If I was a tree" as a satire on Social discrimination?
19. Describe the final meeting between the king and Mary in "Watchman of the Lake".
20. Why wasn't Frederick Douglass affected by his mother's death?
21. In what ways were the two boys useful to the narrator in "Two Gentlemen of Verona"?
22. What transformation in the perception of love do you see in the poem "Do not ask of me my love"?

III. Answer any One of the following in about 200 words. 1x6=6

23. Why do you think Babar Ali took initiative to start his own school in his village? Explain.

OR

The poem "Farmer's wife" highlights the plight of widows after the death of husbands. How? Explain.

OR

How did Mary treat the fisherman and the visitor? What was his relation to his son?



- IV. Read the following passages and answer the questions set on it in a word, a phrase or in a sentence.

1042 ~ 110

Life is a mixture of 'The pleasant' and 'The Unpleasant' of 'Joy and sorrow'. As the Psalmist says: Weeping may endure for night but joy cometh in the morning. Joy and sorrow follow each other as day follows night but when suffering comes, the period appears to be long. A year of joy is but as a day and a day of suffering appears longer than a year.

Suffering is a part of life. It is a teacher. We would miss some of the best lessons of life if suffering did not come to us. When trouble approaches, we try to run away from it; but trouble can never be avoided. The unpleasant experience reaches only for a while to return to us again. By avoiding trouble we invite greater trouble at a later stage. There are some who knowing that trouble can't be avoided say, "What cannot be cured that must be endured." But there is third way? Meeting trouble. It is the only right way. The first way, the way of avoiding trouble is folly. The second - the way of becoming resigned to 'Ardur's' ignorance. The third is the way of greeting every unpleasant experience as friend. Move forward to meet trouble to greet it with the words "Welcome! Friend! What message do you bring to me from God?" And you'll find that every trouble is pocket sized suitable, but which contains a precious gift. Every unpleasant experience is a package which hides - Wealth of wisdom and strength, the Person, who knows this greets suffering with smile. He's a true victor and his way is the way to victory.

24. According to the Psalmist what is life?
25. How do joy and sorrow follow each other?
26. When does the period appear to be long?
27. When would we miss some of the best lessons of life?
28. What do we do when trouble approaches?
29. What would happen if we avoid trouble?
30. Add a suitable prefix to the word 'avoidable' to make it an antonym.
31. With what words do we greet trouble?
32. Write the expression which means 'happiness' in the passage.
33. Who is a True Victor?

equal the necessary amount)

V. A) Fill in the blanks with Articles and Prepositions given in brackets.  
[ 1 x 4 = 4 ]

33. Once upon a time \_\_\_\_\_ elephant made a friendship with a man. One day \_\_\_\_\_ heavy thunder storm broke out, the Elephant went \_\_\_\_\_ his friend who had a little hut at the edge \_\_\_\_\_ the forest.  
[ of, on, a, the, to, for ]

B) Fill in the blanks with suitable form of Verbs given in brackets.  
[ 1 x 4 = 4 ]

35. Mary and a friend of his \_\_\_\_\_ (lay) a trap and \_\_\_\_\_ (watch) a barking dog. As they had to divide it equally between them, they \_\_\_\_\_ (share) it near to the stream, skinned it cleaned and \_\_\_\_\_ (divide) the meat.

C) Choose the correct form of the Verb that agrees with the subject.  
[ 1 x 2 = 2 ]

38. The narrator \_\_\_\_\_ (watch) / (watched) a crowded restaurant. He \_\_\_\_\_ (eat) / (eats) a full meal consisting of Chapatti and meat curry. He drank tea as well. The bill \_\_\_\_\_ (come) / (comes) / (brought) eleven rupees.

D) Correct the following sentences and rewrite them again. [ 1 x 2 = 2 ]

37. One of my friend is in Mysore.

39. What you are doing?

H) Rewrite as directed. [ 1 x 4 = 4 ]

38. When Raja was in the hospital, his mother \_\_\_\_\_ (look) / (looked) after his children.

[ Fill in the blank with appropriate word given in bracket. ]

39. Shashita learnt the correct \_\_\_\_\_ (Pronoun) of the words.

[ Complete the sentence with the right form of the word given in bracket. ]

41. But (because) / (the common) / (because) / (the

[ Rearrange the segments below in a meaningful sentence ]

42. The Creeper has small leaves.

(Add suitable question tag)

43. Frederick Douglass escaped slavery in 1838.

(Change into a question beginning with the right form of *do*.)

44. Rabat, Morocco is the youngest headmaster in the world.

Form a question so as to get the underlined word as answer.

VI. A) Study the TV Programme list below and answer the questions set out B. (4 x 1 = 4)

| Prochardham  | ETV         | Flamery    |
|--------------|-------------|------------|
| 1.30         | 10.00       | 4.00       |
| Krishi Jagat | News        | Cartoon    |
| 8.30         | 12.30       | 10.30      |
| News         | Parbhaya    | Asia today |
| 11.30        | 4.00        | 1.00       |
| Bhuvanam     | Bhuvanam    | Widowhood  |
| 1.30         | 1.00        | 1.00       |
| Film songs   | Prochardham | Widowhood  |

45. i) What T.V. Channel Telecasts news at 8.30?

ii) What can you watch on Flamery channel at 1.00 O'clock?

iii) At what time does Prochardham telecast Bhuvanam?

iv) Which of the above channels present programmes on Bhuvanam?

B) 46. You need a study certificate from the Principal of your college. write a letter including the following points:

(4=4)

\* Your admission number, year of study

make two necessary changes:

- Why do you need it?
- When and where it has to be submitted?

27. Match the expression under Column 'A' to its corresponding language under 'B'.  
1 x 20%

| A                                 | B                   |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------|
| Expressions                       | Functions           |
| 1. Could you please pass the salt | introducing         |
| 2. I am very upset to hear that   | gratitude           |
| 3. Hi! This is Pooja              | greeting            |
| 4. Good evening                   | requesting          |
| 5. Thanks a lot                   | expressing sympathy |

28. Complete the dialogue.  
1 x 20%

|              |   |                              |
|--------------|---|------------------------------|
| 29. Customer | : | I would like to buy a laptop |
| Shop keeper  | : | _____                        |
| Customer     | : | Let me see them              |
| Shop keeper  | : | _____                        |
| Customer     | : | I want some good model       |
| Shop keeper  | : | _____                        |
| Customer     | : | Please give me that one.     |
| Shop keeper  | : | _____                        |

30. Dialogue writing  
1 x 20%

Mahya and Arya meet and discuss their achievements in the annual sports meet. Create a dialogue between them.

-----

## First PLC Annual Examination, February – 2017

Subject: ENGLISH

Time: 2 Hours 15 Mins

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Instructions:

- Read all the instructions carefully.
- Follow the procedure below when answering the questions.
- Write the correct question number clearly, with appropriate key words/signs in the margin against every question so that the invigilator can
- in the hall light check questions during the exam; answer each correctly.



## I. Answer the following questions in a word, a phrase or in a sentence each.

[10 x 1] = 10

- Why did the boys consider the prisoners to appear in "The Government of the Tongue"?
- In "The School Day", the title is a good illustration of \_\_\_\_\_  
as it is a good illustration of the story.
- Where does the doctor find according to "Auntie's Medical Case"?
- Why did the mother feel uneasy gradually in "The Household"?
- What does the husband and son want to know from the mother in "The Household"?
- How many children did the mother have according to "The Household"?
- Where is the doctor located from the doctor according to the speaker in "It's a Good Day"?
- Which goddess was worshipped in "The Household"?
- The phrase "success of my work" in "The Household" suggests \_\_\_\_\_  
as it is a good illustration of the children of the mother.
- What is the name of the children of the mother in "The Household"?
- How much time did the mother spend from a mother to her children from the mother?
- From the name of the mother and her son in "The Household"?

## II. Answer any 10 of the following, choosing either two from part (a) in a paragraph of 90-100 words each.

[10 x 2] = 20

- What the mother gives to the children of the mother in "The Household"?
- Why is the boy referred to as "The School Day"?
- Explain how the mother is a mother in "Auntie's Medical Case"?
- Explain the relationship between the mother and the mother in "The Household"?
- "If you have a wife from there surely is a way there is a thought in it" (The Household)
- What is the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?
- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?

## III. Answer 05 of the following in about 200 words.

[5 x 4] = 20

- Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?

[100]

Explain the name of the mother in "The Household"?

[100]





13. Match the negative under column A to its corresponding negative function under B. 100-15

| A                                                   | B                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1. We were afraid of you.                           | a. surprising        |
| 2. How are you doing as far as school is concerned? | b. complimentary     |
| 3. I am extremely sorry.                            | c. being full of joy |
| 4. I need help?                                     | d. grateful          |
| 5. Hello! How are you?                              | e. grateful          |

14. Complete the following dialogues. 100-16

14. a. Peter goes to school before he finds a computer in the first two years.  
 Peter: I find learning fun.  
 Margaret: ..... what was it like for you? (1) Learning?  
 Peter: I had fun.  
 Margaret: .....? (2) Learning information?  
 Peter: I had fun in the first. I think, my parents were probably jealous.  
 Margaret: well, what was it like for you?  
 Peter: ..... (3) Learning information?  
 Margaret: Oh, that is a computer will look in the future.  
 Peter: ..... (4) Learning.

15. Complete the following. 100-17

Read the following passage. Write a paragraph about the following. Write a paragraph about the following. Write a paragraph about the following. Write a paragraph about the following.



**TOHIORE**

**[M - 2017]**

**Subject Code: 02 (NS)**

**3831925**

**ENGLISH**

**Time : 3 Hours (150 Minutes)**

**(Total No. of questions : 50)**

**Max. Marks : 100**

- Instructions :**
1. Follow the procedure laid while answering the questions.
  2. Write the correct question number in it against all the question paper.
  3. One mark question attempted more than once will be awarded zero.
  4. Answers to question number 21 (a-f) and 25 (a-d) should be in sequence with one place.
  5. For Multiple Choice questions choose the correct answer and mark it.

1. Answer the following questions in a word, a phrase or a sentence each :  
(10 × 1 = 10)

- 1) Where did the criminal go to hide his driver's "Taxi Driver"?
- 2) Whom does "my friend" refer to in the poem "On Children"?
- 3) What is "Chitra's movement" according to Yashoda Bhargava?
- 4) Name the Māhātma (great leader).
- 5) How much of Faizullah's best did Saadullah finally acquire all that?

**P.T.O.**

30 (A6)

READING

1. (1) What would you like to be a factory or an office in the poem "The Last Leaf" by Frost?
  - (2) What was Rogers's first theory about the leaves falling in an English version?
  - (3) According to the poet Keats, "Season" is \_\_\_\_\_
    - a) with it is
    - b) an April
    - c) no other
  - (4) What are naturally expensive in Brazil?
  - (5) What was Marlow like in the beginning of "The Heart of Darkness"?
  - (6) Why did some women prefer "gender" style?
  - (7) What was one of the reasons for a \_\_\_\_\_ (old poem) poem?
2. Answer **only FIVE** of the following questions (showing at least two from **each** in a paragraph of 30 to 100 words) (5 × 4 = 20)
- (1) Why did the character have to accept that the poem is "The Last"?
  - (2) How is the poem and children relationship brought out in Karl Ove's poem "On Childhood"?
  - (3) With a guide on finding Okech's involvement in Okech's involvement?

# QUESTIONS

40 points

1. How is education from the 19th century different from the education of the 20th century?
2. How do the parents of the 19th century differ from the parents of the 20th century?
3. How do the teachers of the 19th century differ from the teachers of the 20th century?
4. How do the students of the 19th century differ from the students of the 20th century?
5. How do the schools of the 19th century differ from the schools of the 20th century?
6. How do the curricula of the 19th century differ from the curricula of the 20th century?
7. How do the methods of the 19th century differ from the methods of the 20th century?
8. How do the results of the 19th century differ from the results of the 20th century?
9. How do the goals of the 19th century differ from the goals of the 20th century?
10. How do the values of the 19th century differ from the values of the 20th century?

# ANSWERS

40 points

1. The 19th century education was more focused on the individual and less on the group. The 20th century education was more focused on the group and less on the individual.
2. The 19th century parents were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century parents were more democratic and less authoritarian.
3. The 19th century teachers were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century teachers were more democratic and less authoritarian.
4. The 19th century students were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century students were more democratic and less authoritarian.
5. The 19th century schools were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century schools were more democratic and less authoritarian.
6. The 19th century curricula were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century curricula were more democratic and less authoritarian.
7. The 19th century methods were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century methods were more democratic and less authoritarian.
8. The 19th century results were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century results were more democratic and less authoritarian.
9. The 19th century goals were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century goals were more democratic and less authoritarian.
10. The 19th century values were more authoritarian and less democratic. The 20th century values were more democratic and less authoritarian.

12 pages

1000000000

12. 24. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

(10 + 4 = 14)

Arunima Datta is the first female attempter to climb Mount Everest. She was once the mascot of the first Indian computer to conquer the heights of Mount Everest.

Arunima was born in 1988 in Arunachal Nagpur of India. Passionate, she has been a national level badminton and table tennis player. On April 2011, she boarded the train Ranthambur Express at Lucknow for Delhi to take an examination to join the CDF. To stretch her legs and give them, she was pushed out of the general compartment by the police. Unfortunately, she fell on a metal parallel track and falling she could get up, as the train crashed for her below the train. She was rushed to the hospital with serious leg and pelvic injuries. To save her life doctors had to amputate the crushed leg. After this accident she was given compensation of more 25,000 rupees by Indian Sports Ministry, which covered medical charges. After the injury, she joined the national team of badminton and a job offer from Indian Railways. She also got recommendations in a job in the IAS. After she had qualified as a head trainee in 2012 in CDF examination.

While her passion was going on at all institutions of Mount Everest. She was inspired by climber Tenzing Norgay who had successfully climbed Everest. She was taught all things everything in life and her strong mind determined to conquer the peak of Mount Everest. So, she contacted Gyaneshwar Puri, the first Indian woman to climb Mount Everest in 2011, and joined her training programme. She climbed Island peak of 8150 metres in 2011 as preparation for her ascent of Everest. On 1 April 2012 Datta and Anshu Malik a TSPF instructor climbed Mount Everest under the leadership of Gyaneshwar Puri and reached the summit of Everest at 8848 m on 21 May 2012. She took

000000

106 *Journal of Management Inquiry* 18(1)

What are other ways to explore / think / write / read?

© 2002 Blackwell Science Ltd, *Journal of Internal Medicine* 252: 105–112

© 2004 Blackwell Publishing Ltd, *Journal of Internal Medicine* 255: 103–110

© 2004 Blackwell Publishing Ltd *Journal of Internal Medicine* 255: 103–110

13. "Dear Mr. [redacted], this refers to [redacted]"

8.8. *Wang et al. (2004) and Wang et al. (2005)*

7. (26) Complete the following by filling the blanks with the right side of the unit sheet if necessary.

The gift of books ..... changed in German handwriting, indicate  
 the source of interest ..... contact with them. But a few years  
 ago ..... shifted to date.

174 | *Abstracts of the 12th Annual Meeting of the European Association of Agricultural Economists*

圖書在版編目(CIP)數據

© 2006 Blackwell Publishing Ltd *Journal of Internal Medicine* 260: 391–400

Copyright © 2003 John Wiley & Sons, Inc.

**Issue** What will be coming to the beach?

**Keywords:** child welfare; foster care; family reunification; permanency

# INTERVIEW

45 min

For Questions for following subject:

(1 + 4 = 5)

(Use suitable adjectives with prepositions)

Example : Good as long as ..... (reducing) in weight  
available energy

What : ..... (2) a girl's ..... (3) a girl's

Name : I have bought some products of daily use. Could you  
divide by them?

Word : ..... + subject if they are available of a domestic  
area.

Answer : Sure Sir, I will deliver the price ..... (4) a girl's

(2) Fill in the blanks by choosing an appropriate word/phrase given in circle :

(1 + 1 = 2)

Following for ..... (1) a girl's ..... (2) a girl's ..... (3) a girl's ..... (4) a girl's

get to know them better (1) a girl's

(3) Fill in the blanks with the right word :

(1 + 1 = 2)

..... + I have bought for some price which is the best  
known. .... (1) a girl's ..... (2) a girl's ..... (3) a girl's

the other aspect of them stands. At the end of the healthy competition  
..... (4) a girl's ..... (5) a girl's

(Answer: 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th)

**READING TEST**

60 (10%)

21) Complete the following dialogue:

(1 + 4 + 4)

(Context: Interview between a HR and a candidate)

**Recruter** : Good morning Sir, ———— ———— introducing to myself, I'm a product manager.

**Candidate** : ———— ———— (only greetings) ———— (after 15 sec)

**Recruter** : I have brought some projects of my job. Could you please see them?

**Candidate** : ———— (after 15 sec) I have no problem of a candidate's job.

**Recruter** : Here I'll tell you the job. ———— (after 15 sec)

22) Fill in the blank by choosing the appropriate expression (after 15 sec):

(1 + 2 + 2)

**Candidate** : ———— **Recruter** : I'm sorry to hear that. Is this report of your company's performance correct? ———— (after 15 sec)

(after 15 sec, 10 sec silence)

23) Fill in the blank with the right phrase:

(1 + 4 + 4)

— ———— **Recruter** : I'm sorry to hear that. Is this report of your company's performance correct? ———— **Candidate** : I'm sorry to hear that. ———— (after 15 sec) I'm sorry to hear that. ———— (after 15 sec) I'm sorry to hear that. ———— (after 15 sec) I'm sorry to hear that.

(after 15 sec, 10 sec silence)

Q2 (10)

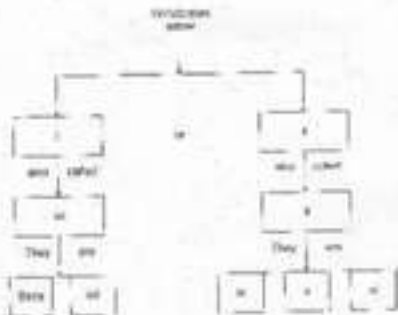
+

QUESTION

Q2. (10) Read the following passage and indicate by drawing (T) for True and (F) for False.

(10 = 10 × 1)

Vertebrate animals can be either warm blooded or cold blooded. A cold blooded means animal whose body temperature. The temperature of their body is dependent on the outside surrounding. Cold blooded animals are also called poikilotherm, which means changeable. They are reptiles, amphibians and fishes. Warm blooded animals are able to regulate their internal temperature. They have hair and feathers to keep their warm. They are also called endotherm, meaning heat within. They are birds and mammals.





**WRITING TASK 1**

10

20-200

- 10) Write a letter of application in response to the following advertisement which appeared in "The Indian Express" dated May 12 2017. (20)

**Required Data (Details included in the advertisement)**

**Qualification:** (i) A. / 2. Class. B. Sc.

**Experience:** Minimum 5 yrs. exp. in the communication field.  
Apply within 20 days.

**to:** The Secretary

Reserve Bank of India

11<sup>th</sup> floor, 4<sup>th</sup> Block

Ministry of Finance

New Delhi

(Write XXX for name and YYY for address)

- 11) a) Imagine you are the College Dean. President, You are given the responsibility of selecting the grant of fee college by the following information. (20)

**Name:** Dr. Jyoti W.S.

**Background:**

**Qualification:** M.Sc., Ph.D.

**Profile:** Excellent in Area Physics, worked as a research

scholar. Publish numerous papers in the field of Physics.

OR

42 (40)

10

100%

- 3) What is what? In this activity, you will be asked to get a sense of how much is taken from the age group of 18 to 20 years. Based on the information given below is the chart.



43. 30) What do the circled words in the following extract refer to? (3 + 3 + 3)

James Bates was inspired by explorer James Smith (1) to feel passionately about cancer. (2) He thought of doing something in his own way (3) using what happened in the case of Mount Everest. James climbed the Everest Peak at last in 2011.

- a) What : \_\_\_\_\_  
 b) He : \_\_\_\_\_  
 c) way : \_\_\_\_\_  
 d) It : \_\_\_\_\_

44) Rewrite the underlined segments in Latin a new style sentences. (2 + 2 + 2)

is / our imagination / an extension only the back / of / our muscles.

\_\_\_\_\_



SUCCESS GUARANTEED  
ONLY AT



**VIKAS**



**VIKAS PRE-UNIVERSITY COLLEGE**

Chief Office at Vengal Rao Nagar, near BSR  
Bosch, Bangalore - 560 003  
For more details visit [www.vikascollege.com](http://www.vikascollege.com)

Ph: 0824 - 2710330, 2710331

Web: [www.vikascollege.com](http://www.vikascollege.com)